Recycle Bin Media
COMPANY PROFILE

letsrewstore@recyclebinmedia.in
www.recyclebinmedia.in

(+91) 7980909989, 8240313964

ABOUT US

Recycle Bin Media is a rapidly expanding media agency based in Kolkata, which was formed and officially established in 2022. However, our roots and collective work date back seven years in the industry. The idea of recycling inspired our agency's name since we strive to efficiently revive all of the squandered or abandoned ideas and concepts and bring in fresh, fruitful strategies by modifying the old ones to assist our clients in achieving their goals. We also take pride in having on board with us a whole team of dedicated, independent creators who contribute to the agency's game plan and bring unique, cutting-edge approaches for various clients and their brands tailored to their precise needs and target audiences.

At Recycle Bin Media, we aim to provide the expertise, connections, and guidance to launch, grow and revamp businesses/ brands of all sizes & categories. Our strength lies in combining strong strategic thinking with refreshing and relevant communication that addresses tangible business problems. Recycle Bin Media has the very potential to become your company's secret elixir that will assist in 360° media coverage and boost engagement to make it more appealing in the eyes of your audience. Making media campaigns successful requires a lot of permutation and combination and let's say it's not very easy if your brand is not in the hands of an agency that does not understand your business's needs. Recycle Bin Media actively collaborates with its client's team to build up its overall brand and business by giving them appropriate exposure through our professional services. We come with years of expertise and capabilities to deliver services in the areas of Content, Design, Web, Video, and Digital.



VISION

To be the leading media agency that revives abandoned ideas and creates innovative, impactful strategies to empower businesses worldwide, ensuring their growth and lasting success in a dynamic media landscape.

MISSION

01. To transform overlooked ideas into innovative, impactful strategies that empower businesses and drive their growth across all media platforms.

02. To deliver customized 360° media solutions through creativity, collaboration, and expertise in content, design, web, video, and digital, ensuring brands connect meaningfully with their audiences



SERVICES

At Recycle Bin Media, we offer a comprehensive range of services designed to elevate your brand and meet your business goals. Our expertise spans content creation, design, web development, video production, and digital marketing, ensuring a 360° approach to brand building. From crafting compelling narratives and designing visually stunning graphics to developing user-friendly websites, producing engaging videos, and executing impactful digital campaigns, we provide end-to-end solutions tailored to your needs. With a team of dedicated creators and strategic thinkers, we focus on delivering innovative, result-driven strategies that resonate with your target audience and drive measurable success.



Recycle Bin Media

PHOTOGRAPHY AND VIDEOGRAPHY

We are a 360-degree video production and photography company equipped to conceptualize, produce, and publish all types of video and photo content. Our visual storytelling prowess is built on a bedrock of scripting, and captivating brand stories across multiple video formats. We firmly believe that no idea cannot be brought to life with the entrancing mix of sound, lights, animation, and action.

Social Media Ads | TVCs | Corporate Videos and Photos | Testimonials | Product Shoots | Portrait, Fashion, Editorial, Architectural, Sports, Event Photography | Reels | Brand Documentary | Promos & Interviews | B2B | Other Collaterals



Recycle Bin Media

CONTENT CREATION

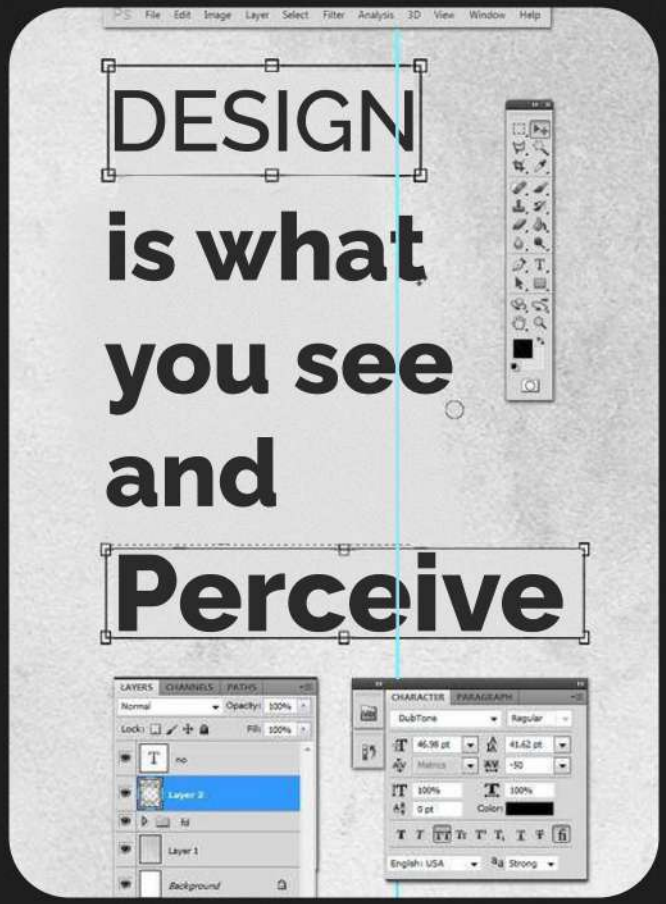
Our content writing services aim to do just one thing- create quality space in your customer's mind for you and your brand. We understand that easy reading is not always easy writing. It has less to do with speaking impressive words and everything to do with creating thoughtful dialogues around big ideas. Less what you say, more how you say it. This is how you stand out from the stream. This is what we have successfully delivered over the years.

Brochures | Flyers | Mailers | White Papers | Case Studies | Articles | Blogs | Master Documents | Websites | Coffee Table Books | Annual Reports |Press Releases | Adverts | Other Collaterals



What is brand storytelling? Using narrative in your marketing.

GRAPHICS DESIGNING



At Recycle Bin Media, great design is not just about the look and feel, it's about how it adds value and makes things work. It is a means to solve a problem, a bridge to fill a communication gap. It is empathy. It is the confidence to stand apart, be loud and clear, and proclaim to the world an idea so real, it stands out for its sheer boldness. And we're here to help you do it

Graphics Designing and Illustration - When it comes to graphics designing we try to create designs that stand out and help the targeted audience understand the brand better with methods such as using brand color schemes, taglines, common messages, etc to create maximum impact.

Branding | Brochures | Flyers | Standees | Datasheets | Hoardings | Packaging | Presentations | Internal Communication | Booklets | Exhibition and Events | Emailers | Business Card | Logo & Signage | Online art | Film and Television Titles and Graphics | T-shirt & Clothing Designs | Other Collaterals

Recycle Bin Media

SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGEMENT

More than one-third of the World's population is on social media, so, what else could be a great place for marketing, other than social media? As a premium Social Media Management Company, we draw traffic and attention towards your website through social media networks, such as Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, YouTube, etc. When you choose us as your social media marketing agency, we will not only help you reach out to your potential customers fast but also their attention by posting engaging and viral social media posts.

Facebook Marketing | Twitter Management | Instagram Management | LinkedIn Management | YouTube Management | Pinterest Management



Recycle Bin Media

DIGITAL MARKETING

In an online landscape that is increasingly summarized by cookie notices, infinite notifications, and persistent pop-ups, nuance is the name of the game. It's no longer about yelling at the top of your voice as much as it's about finding your people and engaging them in a wholesome manner that is both enriching and thoughtful. We'll help you hear what your audience has to say, sound out your messages, speak your truth to your people, and help grow your business by directing the right audience to you.

Social Media Marketing | Lead Generation | Content Marketing | Search Engine Marketing | Influencer Marketing | Email Marketing | Search Engine Optimization | Other Collaterals





DEVELOPMENT & UI/UX

Recycle Bin Media specializes in Website Design, Development, Digital Marketing, and App Design services. Our skilled team delivers brand-focused, high-performing solutions within deadlines, ensuring exceptional user experiences. We craft accessible, engaging, and tailored online personas that connect businesses with their customers. Whether you're a small, medium, or large corporation, we're here to create websites that meet your unique needs.





MOTION GRAPHICS & VIDEO EDITING

Recycle Bin Media also offers Motion Graphics Video services, using text, icons, shapes, and charts to visually communicate complex ideas. Our team creates dynamic, engaging videos that simplify abstract concepts, making them easy to understand and memorable. This service is perfect for digital products or complex services that are challenging to depict directly.

3D Explainer Video | Brand Video | Educational Video | Educational Video Series | Internal Video | 2D Animated | Explainer Video | Social Video Ads | Storytelling | Testimonial Video | Trade Show Video | Other Collaterals

PUBLIC RELATION

At Recycle Bin Media, we consider public relations a crucial business tool that works to tell the right people about your company's products, services, and ideas, your philosophy, and your motivations; in the right way. Sometimes, PR involves writing and disseminating a media release to targeted media, sometimes it involves speaking directly to the consumer via social networking platforms or through clever activations -in any case, PR is all about communicating. And that's what we do best.

Corporate Communications | Media Relations | Community Relations | Crisis Managerment | Event Management Press Release | Brand Building | Brand Strategies and Marketing Campaigns |Other Collaterals



Recycle Bin Media

ARTIST MANAGEMENT

Our artist management portfolio features an impressive lineup of talents, including celebrated Tollywood stars like Nusrat Jahan, Yash Dasgupta, Priyanka Sarkar, and more. These artists have spearheaded impactful campaigns for top-tier brands such as Myntra, Flipkart, Nothing Phone, Thums Up, Budweiser, Pulsar, Boat, Streak, Eveready, Too Yumm, McDowell's, MTV, Vivo, Red Bull, and Dream11, among others.

We also manage nationally renowned music artists like EPR Iyer, Cizzy, and others who have created jingles for over 30+ brands, ensuring top-notch musical branding that resonates with audiences.



INFLUENCER CAMPAIGNS

At Recycle Bin Media, we manage a diverse network of influencers across India, catering to both national and regional campaigns. Our influencers have collaborated with renowned brands like Eveready, L'Oréal, Louis Philippe, Turtle, Nivea, and Times Music, creating impactful and memorable campaigns.

Beyond big-name brands, our influencers have also partnered with numerous food and beverage outlets across Kolkata, helping local businesses build a strong connection with their target audiences. From lifestyle and fashion to beauty, music, and F&B, our influencers come from varied niches, ensuring the perfect fit for your brand's unique requirements.

Our extensive reach and expertise allow us to strategically engage influencers who resonate with your audience, crafting campaigns that are not only relatable but also drive measurable results. Whether it's launching a new product, promoting a service, or amplifying your brand story, our influencer campaigns are designed to leave a lasting impact.



OUR WORK

FASHION AND LIFESTYLE

- **A N John Salons and A N John Academy**
  1 year 3 months

  Delivered 360-degree media solutions, including social media management, graphics, and content creation, which boosted sales and database growth.

- **Infinityy Jewels**

  1 year 6 months (still running)

  Offered end-to-end media services like PR, shoots, and motion graphics, driving consistent customer engagement and sales growth.

- **Turtle (Clothing Brand)**
  6 months retainership, followed by project-based work

  Supported e-commerce operations with shoots, graphics, social media content, and impactful reels, enhancing digital sales.

- **Sylvan Ply (Plywood Brand)**
  6 months

  Delivered creative and strategic media solutions that strengthened their brand identity and market visibility.

- **Eternal Sounds (Music Label)**
  4 months retainership, followed by on-and-off music video projects

  Provided marketing strategies and visual campaigns that boosted their prominence in the music industry.

- **Image Clinic (Aesthetic Clinic)**
  4 months

  Executed branding strategies that enhanced their positioning and client engagement in the competitive aesthetic industry.

FOOD & BEVERAGE (FNB)

- **What's Up Café**
  Project-based
  Created engaging video content that amplified their social media presence, driving customer interest.

- **Mugs and Shots**
  6 months
  Delivered comprehensive media solutions, including creative campaigns and social media management, resulting in higher engagement and sales.

- **TBL (The Bar and Lounge) and Bengal Dhaba (Speciality Group LLP)**
  1 year
  Offered 360-degree media support to enhance their online visibility, footfall, and sales.

- **WOW Momo Foods**
  year (still running)
  Provided 360-degree media services for brands like WOW! Momo Instant, Coco Charge, WOW! Kulfi, WOW! China Diner, and WOW! China, driving database growth and impactful marketing campaigns.

- **Ambuja Neotia Group Restaurants & Lounges**
  1 year 2 months
  Managed media campaigns for outlets such as Afraa Restaurant and Lounge, Conclave Club, Loafers Café (Southern Avenue & Patna), Afraa Deli, UNO Chicago Bar & Grill (Newtown), Tiffin (Swabhumi), Afraa Patna, Sonar Tori, and Orient, boosting footfall, brand recognition, and audience engagement.

- **Bianco and Kinky's**
  6 months
  Delivered tailored strategies and campaigns, improving market presence and brand reach.



- **Trincas**
  5 months
  Conducted recipe videos, shoots, and media strategies to enhance their customer engagement.

- **Zaranj**
  8 months
  Offered 360-degree media services that bolstered their market presence and brand identity.

- **Broadway Group (Flavours of India, Hotel Utsav, Broadway Hotel)**
  1 year 6 months (still running)
  Created tailored campaigns and marketing strategies, enhancing visibility and customer loyalty.

- **8th Day Café**
  2 months
  Produced strategic shoots and content to improve their brand presence in the café industry.

- **The Fat Little Penguin**
  7 months
  Crafted promotional content and campaigns to showcase their artisanal ice cream, boosting engagement.

- **Bunaphile Café**
  5 months
  Delivered comprehensive solutions that enhanced their audience engagement and branding.

- **Vedic Village Spa Resorts**
  4 months
  Created tailored marketing strategies for their restaurants and banqueting, improving brand

- **Wat-a-Paan**
  3 months (still running)
  Developed media strategies to position this QSR unit as a leading brand in the Eastern region.

- **Ganguram Original**
  6 months (still running)
  Created tailored media campaigns for their pan-India e-commerce and offline sweet stores, enhancing their reach.

- **TGIF (International Chain)**
  3 months
  Developed impactful media strategies and campaigns, strengthening their market presence.

OUR WORK
OTHER CLIENTS

- **Impakto Shoes**
  1 year (still running)
  Managed creative campaigns to establish their presence across regional and national markets.
- **Ajanta Shoes**
  7 months (still running)
  Designed impactful marketing strategies to reinforce their position as a leading footwear brand.
- **Kutchina (Kitchen and Modular)**
  1 year (still running)
  Delivered creative media solutions that elevated their market positioning and audience reach.
- **Ambuja Neotia Malls**
  Project-based
  Provided innovative campaign strategies to enhance footfall and consumer engagement.
- **Paw Story (Pet Clinic and Store)**
  4 months from launch
  Created strategic campaigns and content to establish their brand presence effectively.
- **Indira Gandhi Memorial High School**
  6 months
  Delivered media strategies and campaigns to drive admissions and boost their reputation.



OUR WORK
BRAND LAUNCHES

- Fashion and Lifestyle:
  Bold N Curve Tattoo Studio, PAW Story, A N John Ballygunge, Infinityy Jewels

- Food & Beverage:
  Kinky's, Sapodilla, Bocha Soda, Hotel Utsav, New Fresco Gelato, Wat-a-Paan, Loafers Café (Patna and Southern Avenue), Afraa Patna, Tiffin (Swabhumi), UNO Chicago (Newtown), Coco Charge, WOW China Diner, WOW Momo Instant, Sapodilla, Bunaphile (Saltlake)

Launched these brands with comprehensive marketing strategies and creative solutions that amplified their presence and resonated with diverse audiences.



INFLUENCER CAMPAIGNS

For Times Music Bangla

- Ki Ekhaan Gaan Banaise (Movie: Sentimental starring Yash Dasgupta and Nussrat Jahan):
  Executed an 80-influencer campaign that made the song viral across platforms, resulting in 3,07,000 reels.
- Dakatiya Banshi (Movie: Bohurupi starring Koushani Mukherjee and Shiboprasad Mukherjee):
  Conducted a 40-influencer campaign that garnered 2,90,000 reels post-launch.
- Eka Raat Shesh (Movie: Sentimental starring Yash Dasgupta and Nussrat Jahan): Managed a 40-influencer campaign leading to 48,000 reels.
- Shimul Polash (Movie: Bohurupi starring Koushani Mukherjee and Shiboprasad Mukherjee):
  Carried out a 40-influencer campaign that resulted in 25,400 reels.



Recycle Bin Media

FOR LOUIS PHILIPPE

Pan-India influencer campaigns during store launches in Kohima, Dimapur, Bhubaneswar, Ganganagar, Delhi, Kolkata, and Jaipur with 15+ local influencers in each region.

FOR EVEREADY

1.Pan-India campaigns with influencers from Odisha, Mumbai, and North India to promote brand awareness.
2. Executed social media ad campaigns featuring Priyanka Sarkar and Mishmee Das.

FOR STYLE BAAZAR

1.Launched the James Long Sarani store with influencers and celebrity endorsements by Nusrat Jahan and Yash Dasgupta.
2. Ran targeted influencer campaigns across Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities in the Eastern Region.

FOR NIVEA

Executed the Nivea Purna Campaign with 20 Kolkata-based influencers to build awareness and engagement.

FOR L'ORÉAL

1. Collaborated with Kolkata influencers for the Casting Crème Gloss campaign.
2.Conducted a 20-influencer campaign for the Hyaluronic Acid Range, boosting

FOR IMPAKTO SHOES

Regular influencer campaigns conducted every two months to expand brand reach and engagement.

FOR A N JOHN SALONS

Occasional influencer campaigns to increase brand awareness.

FOR WOW MOMO FOODS

1. WOW Momo Instant: Monthly influencer campaigns to drive product trials and awareness.
2. WOW Kulfi: Monthly influencer campaigns with a focus on regional reach.
3. WOW Momo and WOW China: Occasional influencer campaigns for targeted marketing.

FOR SKIPPER FURNISHING

Occasional influencer campaigns for market awareness and product visibility.

FOR LOCAL BUSINESSES

Executed multiple influencer campaigns for:

Hotel Utsav, Flavours of India, All Ambuja Neotia brands, Bianco, Kinky's, PAW Story, Mala Sarees, Bunaphile, Bold n Curve Tattoos, Vedic Village Spa Resorts, TGI Fridays, Sapodilla, Infinityy Jewels, Afraa Restaurant and Lounge, Conclave Club, Loafers Café (Southern Avenue & Patna), Afraa Deli, UNO Chicago Bar & Grill (Newtown), Tiffin (Swabhumi), Afraa Patna, Sonar Tori, and Orient

These campaigns were tailored to enhance brand visibility, performance, and engagement while building a strong brand identity across markets.



OUR CLIENTS

















































Recycle Bin Media

PR COVERAGES

Food & Beverage (FnB)

FOOD

ENJOY A WHOLESOME WINTER BRUNCH AT THE CONCLAVE AT CITY CENTRE SALT LAKE

A warm brunch while soaking up the winter sun seems like the best way to spend a weekend as the city finally experiences a dip in the temperatures. At The Conclave's comprehensive Sunday brunch, called Yesterday, you can do just that. With a menu comprising salads, chaats, an array of desserts and much more, The Conclave is hosting a fulfilling brunch with multiple options.

What: Yesterday, a winter brunch
Where: The Conclave, City Centre Salt Lake
When: Every Sunday, noon to 4.30pm
Pocket Pinch: Rs 1,495 plus for one

"Winters are incomplete without brunch on Sundays, and The Conclave is known for its traditional Sunday brunch. This year we are calling it "Yesterday" as it's a tribute to the bygone era and old Calcutta cuisine. The spread is huge and it's especially curated to ensure that it leaves people with food nostalgia," said Nitin Kohli, director, Ambuja Neotia Group.

"What's better than catching up with friends over a Sunday brunch with unlimited food and drinks. The Conclave, like every year, has come up with an amazing spread of Sunday brunch which will make your palate walk through the old streets of Calcutta," added Ayan Mitra, general manager, Altair.

Here are our picks from the brunch menu and some glimpses from the launch of the brunch.



Chef Ghanashyam with Chef Srijan of The Conclave



Runa Laha



Ayan Mitra, general manager, AltAir



Sayantani Guha Thakurta



Rapper EPR



Sean Banerjee



Start your meal with your choice of salad from the vast number of choices available. There are both vegetarian as well as non-vegetarian options present like the Mediterranean Quinoa Salad, Tossed Salad and more.



End your meal on a sweet note at the dessert corner with options aplenty, with both traditional Indian sweets and more contemporary options available like the chocolate Monte Carlo, assorted tarts and mousse and rasgullas.



Roast Chicken with Honey Chili Sauce: A balanced mix of sweet and spicy come together in this delicious dish. The sauce helps cut through the richness of the meat, preventing the dish from being too overpowering.



Spinach Cheese Cannoli: Creamy and fresh, this cannoli makes for the perfect bite to get your meal started.



Prawn Cocktail: If you are a seafood lover, do not miss out on this classic. It comes with freshly cooked, soft prawns in creamy cocktail sauce.



Lynchburg Lemonade: Have a refreshing sip of this lemonade, made with fresh seasonal fruits, to cleanse your palate in between dishes.



Papdi Chaat: If you are a fan of chaats, don't miss out on this delicious chaat that brings a mix of spicy, sweet and tangy to the dish with a fresh mix of chopped tomatoes and potatoes, various kinds of chips and chutney.



Spicy Litchi Margarita: Craving a bit of spice with your drinks? Don't miss out on this Cocktail. However, the spice is not strong and remains in a refreshing tandem with the sweetness of the litchi.



Mutton Rogan Josh: Among the many main course dishes available, there is the warm and delicious Mutton Rogan Josh which comes with mildly spicy gravy and soft and chewy meat.

Sudarshana Ganguly (LJ intern)
Pictures: B. Halde





Classy interiors of the restaurant

A SMORGASBORD OF FINE TASTE

Fine diner Zaranj's newly opened exclusive Platinum Dining section offers bespoke gourmet experiences for any special occasion

THE GEN-X WHO spent their teens and adulthood in erstwhile Calcutta of the 90s are perhaps the only generation to witness the absolute transformation of the city's foodscape to what it is today — a booming and ever-growing sector with a dozen new diners sprouting up at a hurried pace across the expanding metropolis. While the 90s and the first decade and a half of the 21st century were all about a few fine diners of repute dotting the famed Park Street area, the Kolkata that we see today has multi-cuisine options at every nook and cranny. But there are a few, who still hold on with grace, poise and distinction, for their impeccable quality of food, old-world charm and spotless service. Zaranj — right at the corner opposite Indian Museum — is definitely one of them, serving patrons with elan since 1991.



A diverse spread of flavours by Zaranj

The Gen-X surely has memories of visiting this opulent standalone gourmet diner serving North-West Frontier cuisine, famed for its succulent *kebabs* and soulful *Daal makhani*. Founded 22 years ago by Deepak Khullar — whose father, Rajpal Khullar, gifted Kolkata Amber in 1957, an ever-popular diner that still offers the finest Mughlai fare — Zaranj, now helmed by young scion Raghav Khullar, continues to serve what it's best known for, besides reinventing its dishes and services to suit the needs of the newer generation too.

Khullar, a well-trained and finicky chef, who has perfected his culinary skills in various parts of Europe, and Hong Kong's two Michelin star diners — New Punjab Club and Belon — is putting his rich experience to work. "At Zaranj we have never compromised on the quality of food served and the ambience; that's what our patrons come back for," says Khullar, as he sits with us for a quick chat on a busy weekday afternoon at Zaranj.

Raghav invited *Indulge* to taste some of the most flavourful *kebabs* and dishes from North-West Frontier that Zaranj is reputed for and he took the opportunity to also share with us his grand plans for the newly-launched section within the restaurant — Zaranj Platinum Dining.

It can accommodate 40 guests for a sit-down affair or 75 for buffet options, and is for those who want a bespoke gustatory experience that doesn't compromise on quality or taste. "We want to give an elevated dining experience to the guests that they will remember for a long time, and that too in a set up that offers the privacy of a family dining hall. Our Platinum Dining section is different from the other private dining rooms in city restaurants in the sense that we won't be serving you the regular menu. Everything is pre-booked and well-curated according to your choice. It's a perfect space for me and other acclaimed visiting chefs to showcase curated *table d'hote* menus to an audience invested in good food," explains Khullar. Be it exotic dishes made with the freshest salmon from the shores of Alaska, or the best quality vegan fare, Zaranj's Platinum Dining will have it all arranged for the patrons and their guests.

Equipped with a private marble bar, a regal dining room, mosaic dinnerware enclosed in copper cloches and a private butler service, Platinum Dining can play host to multiple occasions such as private dining, birthdays, anniversaries, events, exhibitions, corporate conferences, ladies' luncheons and more.

It offers 3/5/7 course table d'hote menus of various cuisines alongside the classic Zaranj *a la carte* option, and is complemented by a bar serving the finest malts, gins and curated cocktails.

For those, looking for a quiet treat at Zaranj, don't miss out on the *kebab* section of the main menu. Raghav, who is extremely passionate about these succulent delicacies, overlooks the grilled fare directly, thereby bringing incomparable finesse and uniqueness to the taste. We were bowled over by the meaty and veg options in the *kebabs* served to us. The must-tries include the very flavourful *Dahi ke kabab* that was distinctly different from the ones served elsewhere simply for the perfect blend of the parched gram flour, hung curd and mild spices, and the juicy *Machli masala kabab* for its well-marinated barbecued *bekti* fillets.

Meal for two: ₹3,500. Timings: 12 noon to 4, and 7pm to midnight.

—Sharmistha Ghosal
sharmishtha.g@newindianexpress.com
@sharmidas





টু মাশরুম ভেলুটে



গুল্ড স্কুল টম্যাটো সুপ

শীতের শুরুতে সুপ-সফর

হিমের পরশ গায়ে লাগতেই গলায় চাই গরম সুপের ছোঁয়া। কয়েক ধরনের সুপ তৈরির সন্ধান দিলেন **শেফ সৃজন শীল**



কানজা দে গালিনহা



চিকেন অ্যান্ড থাইম সুপ

গুল্ড স্কুল টম্যাটো সুপ

উপকরণ: টম্যাটো ২০০ গ্রাম, নুন ও চা-চামচ, সাদা তেল আধ, চিনি ও চা-চামচ, অলিভ অয়েল পরিমাণ মতো, বেসিল-সেলেরি-থাইম অমিয়ন বা লিক এক আঁটি করে, ৪-৫টি মাঝারি মাপের পেঁয়াজ, রসুন ৪ কোয়া, কুকিং ক্রিম ২-৩ টেবিল চামচ, মাখন ২-৩ টেবিল চামচ, পার্মেজান চিজ় পরিমাণ মতো, পাউরুটির টুকরো ১টি, গোলমরিচ সামান।

প্রণালী: আভেন প্রি-হিট করে নিন। আধ অলিভ অয়েলে টম্যাটো দিয়ে নুন, গোলমরিচ, কিছুটা পেঁয়াজ, রসুন কুচি, থাইম অমিয়ন আর সেলেরি পরপর মিশিয়ে টস করে নিতে হবে। এর পরে এই টস করে রাখা টম্যাটোগুলি বেকিং শিটে ছড়িয়ে দিয়ে ৪০ মিনিট ধরে রোস্ট করে নিন। মাঝারি আঁচে স্টকপট বসিয়ে তাতে অলিভ অয়েল দিয়ে বাকি পেঁয়াজ আর রসুন কুচি দিয়ে নাড়াচড়া করুন। রোস্টেড টম্যাটোর পিউরি করে নিয়ে এতে মিশিয়ে দিন। পরিমাণ মতো নুন, চিনি মেশান। আধ আধ করে স্টক মিশিয়ে নাড়াচাড়া করুন। শেষে বেসিল দিন। কুকিং ক্রিম আর চিজ় মেশান শেষে। আঁচ কমিয়ে বেশ কিছুক্ষণ ধরে ফুটিয়ে নামিয়ে নিন। মাখন-মাখানো পাউরুটির সঙ্গে পরিবেশন করুন এই সুপ।

ক্রিমি অ্যাসপারাগাস সুপ

উপকরণ: আসপারাগাস ৪০ গ্রাম, নুন পরিমাণ মতো, অলিভ অয়েল ১০ চা-চামচ, চিনি ৫ চা-চামচ, লিক-সেলেরি এক আঁটি, পেঁয়াজ ৪-৫টি (কুচি করে কাটা), রসুন ৫ কোয়া, কুকিং ক্রিম ৪-৫ টেবিল চামচ, মাখন ২৫ গ্রাম, পার্মেজান চিজ় ২৫ গ্রাম।

প্রণালী: একটি ভারী পাত্রে মাখন আর অলিভ অয়েল মাঝারি আঁচে গরম করুন প্রথমে। রসুন দিয়ে গন্ধ ছাড়লেই তাতে আসপারাগাস দিয়ে নুন-মরিচ দিয়ে নাড়াচাড়া করুন মিনিট পাঁচেক। পেঁয়াজ কুচি, লিক-সেলেরি কুচি করে দিয়ে দিন। এতে ব্রথ ঢেলে ঢাকা দিয়ে আর ৫ মিনিট পানেরো রান্না করুন। আসপারাগাস সিদ্ধ হয়ে নরম হয়ে এলেও সবুজ থাকবে। ঠান্ডা করে মিক্সারে ঢেলে পিউরি বানিয়ে নিন। তা ছেঁকে আঁচে বসিয়ে ক্রিম, চিজ় মিশিয়ে ঘন করে নিন। নামানোর আগে নুন-চিনি-মরিচ আলতো ছড়িয়ে নিলেই তৈরি ক্রিমি আসপারাগাস। শেষে ক্রিম ও হার্বস দিয়ে গার্নিশ করে নিন।

চিকেন অ্যান্ড থাইম সুপ

উপকরণ: বোনলেস চিকেন ১০০ গ্রাম, থাইম আধ আঁটি, পার্সলে, লিক ও সেলেরি অল্প করে, নুন ও চিনি পরিমাণ মতো, গোলমরিচ গুঁড়ো অল্প, অলিভ অয়েল ২-৩ টেবিল চামচ, পেঁয়াজ ৩-৪টি, রসুন ৫ কোয়া, তেজপাতা ২টি, কুকিং ক্রিম আর কাপ, মাখন ২-৩ টেবিল চামচ, পার্মেজান চিজ় অল্প, ময়দা ৩-৪ চামচ।

প্রণালী: কড়াইয়ে মাখন গরম করে পেঁয়াজ কুচি, রসুন কুচি দিয়ে একে একে সেলেরি আর লিক দিতে হবে। একটু পর ময়দা মিশিয়ে ভাল করে নাড়তে হবে। আগে থেকে সিদ্ধ করে রাখা চিকেনের ব্রথ মেশান। পার্সলে, থাইম, তেজপাতা একসঙ্গে বেঁধে সুপের মধ্যে ফেলে দিয়ে আঁচ কমিয়ে মিনিট পনেরো রান্না করতে হবে। নুন, চিনি দিন পরিমাণ মতো। সিদ্ধ করে রাখা চিকেন মিশিয়ে ভাল করে ফুটিয়ে গ্যাস বন্ধ করে দিন। সুপের মধ্যে দেওয়া পার্সলে-থাইম-তেজপাতা তুলে নিয়ে ফেলে দিন। কুকিং ক্রিমের সঙ্গে সামান্য নুন, গোলমরিচ মিশিয়ে সুপে দিয়ে দিন। সুপ বোলে ঢেলে উপরে চিজ়, পার্সলে কুচি ছড়িয়ে ব্রেড রোলের সঙ্গে সার্ভিয়ে দিন।



ক্রিমি অ্যাসপারাগাস

টু মাশরুম ভেলুটে

উপকরণ: ফ্রেশ বাটন মাশরুম ১৫০ গ্রাম, শিতাকে মাশরুম ২০ গ্রাম, নুন ২ চা-চামচ, অলিভ অয়েল ২ টেবিল চামচ, চিনি স্বাদমতো, থাইম, সিজ ও সেলেরি আর আঁটি, পেঁয়াজ ৪টি, রসুন কোয়া ৫-৬টি, কুকিং ক্রিম আর কাপ, পার্সলে কুচি অল্প, মাখন ২-৩ কিউব, পার্মেজান চিজ় ১/৪ কাপ, ময়দা অল্প, ভেজিটেবল স্টক এক কাপ।

প্রণালী: একটি বড় পাত্রে মাখন গরম করে পেঁয়াজ কুচি আর রসুন কুচি দিয়ে নাড়াচড়া করুন, যতক্ষণ না তা নরম হয়ে আসছে। তাতে বাদামি করে ফেলবেন না। এ বার বাটন এবং শিতাকে মাশরুম দিয়ে আর ৩ মিনিট খানেক ভাল করে ফুটিয়ে নিন, নরম হয়ে আসবে। এতে সামান্য ময়দা ছড়িয়ে নাড়তে থাকুন। ভেজিটেবল স্টক মেশান। ভাল করে ফুটলে লিক, সেলেরি, থাইম মিশিয়ে দিন। হয়ে গেলে আঁচ থেকে নামিয়ে ঠান্ডা করে ব্লেন্ডারে দিয়ে মসৃণ পেস্ট করে নিন। আবার প্যানে চাপিয়ে এতে ক্রিম, চিজ় আর শেষে পার্সলে কুচি ছড়িয়ে পরিবেশন করুন। উপরে কয়েকটি মাশরুমের টুকরো কেটে সাজিয়ে দিন। মাখনে সামান্য হার্বস মিশিয়ে তা ব্রেড রোলে মাখিয়ে খেতে পারেন সুপের সঙ্গে।

কানজা দে গালিনহা

উপকরণ: বোনলেস স্কিনলেস চিকেন ব্রেস্ট/থাই ২টি, অলিভ অয়েল ১ টেবিল চামচ, পেঁয়াজ ১/২টি, রসুন কুচি ২ কোয়া (অথবা গ্রার্লিক্রিয়ান সোচিফো ২ টেবিল চামচ), মোটা টম্যাটো ৩টি (সেদ্ধ করা), ফ্রেশ থাইম সামান্য, জল বা চিকেন স্টক আধ কাপ ও চিকেন ব্রথ ২ চা-চামচ একসঙ্গে মেশানো, বড় গ্যাজর ৩টি (ধোয়া করে কাটা), সেলেরির ছোট আঁটি কুচি করা ১টি, আলু টুকরো করা ২টি, ঢাল আধ কাপ, নুন ও গোলমরিচ স্বাদ অনুযায়ী।

প্রণালী: চিকেনের টুকরোগুলি নুন আর গোলমরিচ মাখিয়ে আলাদা করে রাখুন। ইনস্টান্ট পট বা কুকারে অলিভ অয়েল গরম করে পেঁয়াজ-রসুন কুচি (অথবা গ্রার্লিক্রিয়ান সোচিফো) হালকা সাতে করে নিন। মিনিট দুয়েক পরে চিকেন দিয়ে দিন। টম্যাটো, থাইম এবং চিকেন স্টক ও গ্রথের মিশ্রণ দিয়ে ঢাকা বন্ধ করে দিন। ২০-২৫ মিনিট পরে আঁচ বন্ধ করে দিন, তারপর বিষ্ণুক্ষণ পরে ঢাকনা খুলুন। টম্যাটোর খোসাগুলি ছেঁকে ফেলে দিন। থাইমের ডাটিও বেছে ফেলে দিন। এ বার একটা কাটের চামচ বা ঘুন্নি দিয়ে চিকেনগুলি টুকরো করে নিন। এ বার এতে গাল, আলাদা মিশিয়ে ৬ কাপ জল দিয়ে ভাল করে ফেটান, যতক্ষণ না তা পুরোপুরি সিদ্ধ হচ্ছে। লাইম আমেরিকান এই চিকেন-বাইস সুপ স্বাদের পাশাপাশি আপনার স্বাস্থ্যেরও খেয়াল রাখবে।

ছবি: নিরুপম দত্ত
রেসিপি সৌজন্য: দা কনক্রেভ

Recycle Bin Media



Interiors



Bread varieties

PET PARADISE

Loafer's Café has several pawsome reasons for you to check out their newest outlet at Southern Avenue this winter

Pics: Anindya Saha



KICKING OFF WINTER mornings with the aroma of freshly baked bread can set the mood for your day ahead. Loafer's Café on Southern Avenue opened a month back to welcome connoisseurs from the early hours of the day along with their pawsome friends looking for a treat. The cafeteria, popular for its house-baked bread, has arrived in this part of the city after much wait and we couldn't hold ourselves back from trying some of their delicacies while swooning over their décor and four-legged beauties visiting the outlet.

The interior decked in subtle amber hues and minimalistic décor will make you feel comfortable and settled with wooden tables and brick walls adding a rustic break to the otherwise polished interiors. The upholstered chairs in grey patterns complement the carpet on the floor. The interiors are divided into two distinct segments which blend finely into an open-air patio in the backyard. The outdoor section is a perfect choice for foodies who want to soak in the winter sunshine while indulging in some delicacies fresh out of the oven. We believe this section is also preferred for pet parents as it adds a touch of the outdoors. Pet parents can also order some cookies and treats to keep their babies engaged.

As we settled at a table on the patio, our senses were filled with the fragrant medley cooking in the kitchen. A heaped plate of perfectly crusted fish and chips soon made its way as we started sipping on a hot cuppa of Earl Grey. Before we get going on the food, we would love to point out how a sand timer adds a special touch to each of your tea orders, as it sets a reminder for you to pour the brew from the pot when it's perfectly emulsified. Moving on to the fish and chips, each plate comes with three large portions of fish fries, a tartar dip and a crunchy salad tossed in vinaigrette. Buttermilk Chicken Bites served with tartar sauce and a portion of salad pose as a delectable chicken alternative to the classic fish dish.

For calorie watchers, the menu dissects each of the dishes, shedding light on the calories that come with it besides the probable allergens. For the mains, one may choose from ample options listed under the Buddha Bowls section. Each bowl is a single-eater meal replete with veggies, a portion of carbs, and choice of meat. Sandwiches, quiches, skillet wraps, or large plates focused on chunks of protein can also be a fitting alternative for the ones looking for less fussy stomach fillers. Their pizzas are made in-house from scratch and we can vouch that their range of tastes and variety of succulent breads are unmatched.

Even though the dessert section offers ample options like Lemon Tart, Banana Walnut Slice, and Victorian Black Forest Pastry to name a few, for a sweet conclusion, take a look at their wide range of bread loaves before you leave. You will surely pick some for home.

Price for two: ₹1,000

— Raima Ganguly
raimaganguly@newindianexpress.com
ganguly_raima

গোয়ালন্দ কাঁকড়া মশলা

■ **উপকরণ:** কাঁকড়া ২টো, হলুদ গুঁড়ো ১৫ গ্রাম, আদা বাটা ১৫ গ্রাম, রসুন বাটা ২০ গ্রাম, টমেটো বাটা ২০ গ্রাম, পেঁয়াজ ৩০ গ্রাম (জুলিয়েন করে কাটা), পেঁয়াজ বাটা ৫০ গ্রাম, দারচিনি ২টো, তেজপাতা ২টো, লবঙ্গ ২টো, এলাচ ৩টে, দই ৪০ গ্রাম, আলু ১টা (১/৪ ভাগ করে কাটা), জিরে গুঁড়ো ২০ গ্রাম, ধনে গুঁড়ো ১৫ গ্রাম, কাশ্মীরি লাললঙ্কা গুঁড়ো ১০ গ্রাম, লাললঙ্কা গুঁড়ো ১০ গ্রাম, গরম মশলা ১৫ গ্রাম, কাঁচা লঙ্কা ৩টে (চেরা), জল ১০০ গ্রাম, নুন, সর্ষের তেল ৭৫ গ্রাম, ঘি ২০ গ্রাম।

গোয়ালন্দ কাঁকড়া মশলা



■ গোয়ালন্দের স্টিমারে মাছ তৈরির রেসিপি অনুযায়ী কাঁকড়ার এই রেসিপি তৈরি।

■ **প্রণালী:** কাঁকড়া ম্যারিনেট করে ছাঁকা তেলে ভেজে তুলে নিন। এবার একই তেলে তেজপাতা, লবঙ্গ, দারচিনি, এলাচ দিয়ে একটু নেড়েচেড়ে পেঁয়াজ দিয়ে হালকা সোনালি করে ভেজে নিন। পেঁয়াজ বাটা মিশিয়ে সোনালি করে ভেজে আদা-রসুন বাটা দিয়ে একসঙ্গে মিশিয়ে নিন। অল্প অল্প করে হলুদ গুঁড়ো, লাললঙ্কা গুঁড়ো, কাশ্মীরি লাললঙ্কা গুঁড়ো, জিরে গুঁড়ো, ধনেপাতা গুঁড়ো মিশিয়ে রান্না করুন। এবার টমেটো বাটা মিশিয়ে, ঢাকা দিয়ে রাখুন। কিছু ক্ষণ পর রান্না হয়ে গেলে ঘি, গরম মশলা, কাঁচালঙ্কা দিয়ে সাজিয়ে ভাতের সঙ্গে পরিবেশন করুন।

যোগাযোগ: ৯০৭৩৩৯৪৫৯১
ছবি: শুভেন্দু চাকী



গোয়ালন্দ কাঁকড়া মশলা

INDULGE INTO SONAR TORI'S MOUTH-WATERING HILSA FESTIVAL CALLED ILISHER ULLASH

The authentic Bengali restaurant in City Centre Salt Lake, Sonar Tori, is known for its home-style Bengali food. Just like every year, the restaurant is celebrating the much-awaited Hilsa festival called Ilisher Ullash, featuring some unique preparations of the fish. From people's favourite Shorshe Ilish to Sosha Ilish, Karamcha Ilish and many more, Ilisher Ullash by Sonar Tori has everything to tantalise your taste buds with curated Hilsa dishes. "In this Hilsa festival, we have used some unique flavours from both Epaar Bangla (West Bengal) and Opaar Bangla (Bangladesh) where Ilish is a famous fish cooked in different styles. We have used cucumber and *karamcha* (Bengal Currant, a kind of sour berry) to create the dishes, which are not generally found in any other F&B places. I hope our patrons come and relish our homemade lost recipe creations," said Chef Bhaskar Dasgupta of Sonar Tori. **t2** gets you the details of the Hilsa festival which is on for a month.



Karamcha Diye Ilish is marinated Hilsa cooked with sour berries that are commonly used as a condiment in Indian pickles. Rs 769



Rajsahi Ilisher Shammi Kebab are small patties of minced and boneless Hilsa flesh mixed with hot spices and served with mango-mint dipping sauce. Rs 579



Sosha Ilish is marinated Hilsa cooked in a light yet unique flavourful broth of cucumber and mustard. Rs 769



Mawa Ghater Ilisher Bharta is fried and mashed Hilsa tail and roe made into balls along with fresh coriander, sliced onion, green chillies and mustard. Rs 749



Nowakhalir Morich Khola Ilish is marinated spicy hilsa wrapped with pumpkin leaf and steamed, served with spicy pumpkin leaf paste. Rs 769



Ilish Macher Chop are Bengali-style croquettes served with Bikrampuri *kasundi*. Rs 579



The Sonar Tori Ilish Plater has Gobindobhog rice, Machher Tel, Ilish Bhaja, Pui Sagh Diye Ilsher Matha, Ilish Shorshe Bata, Begun Bhaja, Ilish Machher Bhorta and *sandesh*. Rs 2,289

Rohini Chakraborty
Pictures: Pabitra Das

FOOD

INDULGE IN SONAR TORI'S SCRUMPTIOUS MANGO FESTIVAL, AAMER UTSAV

Sonar Tori at City Centre Salt Lake is celebrating summer and the onset of monsoon with the king of fruits, with Aamer Utsav, which is on till July 15. This food fest has been curated with the lost recipes of Bengali cuisine amalgamated with mangoes. From chicken to fish, each and every dish has been exquisitely created using mangoes with different flavours. Whether it's Aam Achar Bhetki Bhapa, Aam Dal or Aam Doi, the dishes are made with both raw and ripe mangoes.

"With Aamer Utsav, we have tried to bring nostalgia to the plates by making every dish with the seasonal mango. We have created all the dishes on the menu with natural products like the *aamer achar*, which is housemade. We want our patrons to visit Sonar Tori to experience our homely and flavourful mango creations," said Chef Bhaskar Dasgupta of Sonar Tori. Here are some of **t2**'s picks from the menu.



Chana Aam Kashundi Paturi is where a block of soft homemade cottage cheese is marinated with mango pickle sauce, wrapped with banana leaf and steamed. Rs 349

If you want something light to go with your steamed rice in the afternoon, try the Mocha Aam Shol, which is a sweet-and-sour banana flower broth. Rs 319

Aam Kashundi Murgi is chicken quenelles tossed with sweet mango *kashundi* sauce to give you that sweet and tangy flavour. Rs 339

Dig into the sinful Aam Doi, which is simply mango-flavoured yoghurt. Rs 109

A bowl of hot mutton gravy is what a Bengali soul craves on a rainy afternoon. Hence try Aam Achar Mangsho made with homemade raw mango pickle. Rs 649

Rohini Chakraborty
Pictures: B Halder

Recycle Bin Media

new menu

Pisces calling

Sonar Tori's *Sonar Illish* festival brings together the best hilsa recipes from both sides of Bengal



Illish machher matha diye pui shaaker chorchori

SONAR TORI AT City Centre, Salt Lake is back this year with a unique milieu of traditional recipes from both sides of Bengal. Titled Sonar Illish Festival, the seasonal menu has introduced ten new entrants, some of which are created by chef Bhaskar Dasgupta himself, while the others are borrowed from his mother's kitchen.

"We at Sonar Tori are experimenting with recipes that are at the edge of extinction from both sides of Bengal. The predominant taste palette that separates dishes from either side is that recipes from Bangladesh are a little higher on the spice scale as compared to West Bengal. Also, unlike people here, Bangals love cooking the fish with garlic and ginger paste," shares chef Bhaskar.

The classic *Illish Macher Diner Bora* made out of hilsa roe, deep fried with sliced onion, green chillies and spices can be the perfect conversation starter while a spicy *Mawa Ghater Illish er Bhortha* is equally heavenly with a plate of hot steamed rice.

For the mains you can go for *Aam Acharer Illish Bhapa*, elevated with sides of pickled mango and mustard paste, *Illish Panikhola* from the kitchens of Barishal has a light stewy aftertaste while Kancha Lonka Illish has a zesty flavour.

On till August 15. Price for two: ₹1,500+

— **Raima Ganguly**
raimaganguly
@newindianexpress.com
@ganguly_raima



Sonartori Illish platter

Chef Bhaskar Dasgupta



seasonal

Interiors

RELISH THE *ILISH!*



ITC Sonar's *Poetry in Cuisine* curated by the kitchens of the Tagore House bring the Bengali bard's favourites to your plate

THE BENGALI CUISINE and its rules change distinctly as one moves from the banks of Padma to the Gangetic plains. While Bangladeshi cuisine leans towards richer gravy and thicker texture with a sharp, spicy palate; the taste on the western side of the border gets milder, with runny gravies possessing a sweet note. But if there's a single unifying item that tickles both tastebuds and the intellect of Bengalis across the two riverine plains and, in fact, any part of the world, it has to be *Ilish* — the besotting queen of fish.

While most of the city diners go all out to offer the best variations of Hilsa during the monsoons, ITC Sonar's Eden Pavilion has taken a very different approach this season by underscoring how the fish has historically been represented in the culinary culture of both Bengals. The hotel has taken help from Sudripta Tagore, a descendant of the famed Tagore family to curate an exotic and varied fare of the silver queen.

Since the times of Prince Dwarkanath Tagore, one of the wealthiest entrepreneurs and influencers in the days of East India Company, the family has been known to entertain a large number of important guests including British aristocrats. Naturally, the kitchen was run by expert chefs including Bamun Thakurs, Khansamas and Bawarchis to deftly handle the traditional Bengali, Middle East and Continental cuisines respectively. "All of these were meticulously overseen by the women of the Tagore household who curated the daily menus. Purnima Tagore and Indu Devi Chaudhurani especially carefully collected and drafted most of the precious recipes in their diaries, often also mentioning the sources of their origin," informs Sudripta. Sudripta's grandmother Purnima Tagore was Rabindranath Tagore's favourite granddaughter-in-law, who used to helm the Tagore kitchen *Dudh narkel ilish* :ky tastebuds of the bard. "Rabindranath was very moody and his food preferences, too, changed with his temper, and my grandmom was the only person who could perfectly read his likings," says Sudripta while talking about the rich culinary history of the Tagore family and how they influenced the course of Bengali culinary culture. "In fact, according to many food researchers, and culinary historical sources and anecdotes, the use of sugar in Bengali cuisine was a symbol of affluence and was introduced by the Tagores," he added.

Though Rabindranath's culinary preferences changed with his fluctuating mood, the presence of ilish on the table was a must during the monsoons, one of his favourite seasons. His pet items included *Doi Ilish* and *Ilish Narkol Dudh Diye*, Sudripta tells us.

In this Hilsa fest, Sudripta has included all the dishes that used to grace the family table through generations and had been favourites among the guests and family members alike. With some unique items including *Ilish* Roast, Smoked *Ilish*, *Bhapa Ilish*, *Ilish Machher Jhol*, *Doi Ilish*, *Ilish Narkol Dudh Diye* and *Sorshe Ilish* — the comprehensive menu at ITC Sonar covers all variations of the celebrated fish.

"Since guests from across the shores were frequently entertained at our home, it was a must to present the desired Hilsa to them, deboned and roasted to appeal to their palate and convenience," Sudripta mentions. We tasted the Roast *Ilish* with accompanying veggies and mashed potato. Roasted in charcoal and jaggery-coated puffed rice, the dish had a distinctly sweet note to it that added more to the flavour.

But what bowled us over was *Ilish Dudh Narkol Diye*. A delicate dish constructed with coconut milk, the item is sublime and irresistible for the way it has melded the strong individual flavour of the fish with that of coconut. No wonder it gladdened the heart of Asia's first Nobel winner.

"This festival of food is in keeping with our ethos to help sustain the intrinsic flavour of this region, part of our initiative towards Responsible Luxury," says Nitin Bahl, hotel manager, ITC Sonar.

Among other dishes, you must savour Ilish Roast and Doi Ilish since both are extremely painstaking to make at home.

At Eden Pavilion. ₹2,500+ per person. Starts today and on till August 28. 12.30 pm to 2.45 pm and 7 pm to 11 pm.

— **Sharmistha Ghosal**
sharmishtha.g
@newindianexpress.com
@sharmidas



Sudripta Tagore



Smoked Ilish

AFRAA LOUNGE HAS LAUNCHED AN ALL-NEW MENU COMPRISING MOUTH-WATERING DELICACIES AND A CURATED COCKTAIL MENU

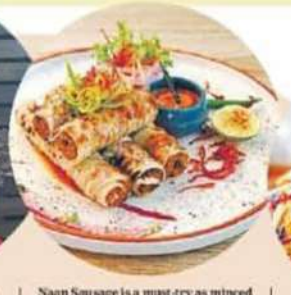
Overlooking the daily humdrum of City Centre Salt Lake, Afraa Lounge is a popular hangout in that part of the city. The eatery has recently launched its brand new menu with some delicious food and curated cocktails. The lounge looks elegant with its modern and chic decor. Apart from Mediterranean and continental cuisine, Afraa's new menu also includes fusion dishes like Kasundi Beckty Chops, Prawn Cocktail, Naan Sausage Roll and many more now along with some Indian specials. Afraa Lounge has also launched a curated gin bar which is the first of its kind in Calcutta. t2 checked out the new menu.



"We launched our very new food and beverage menu to enhance our guests' experience at Afraa. The must-try dishes would be our Naan Sausage, Prawn Cocktail, Pull Apart Cheese Buns and Ghee Roast Mutton Kulcha and many more. We have also launched our very own Gin Cocktail Bar, which is so far the first gin bar in Calcutta with a specially curated gin cocktail menu," said Somnath Dutt, operations manager of Afraa.



The Excalibur Sangria Punch is a fruity concoction of Merlot wine with aromatic saffron gin and brandy infused with exotic fruits.



Naan Sausage is a must-try as minced chicken kebab is gently wrapped in naan dough and cooked in tandoor. Served with BBQ cucumber dip.



The Pull Apart Cheese Buns are for cheese and bread lovers as oven-fresh buns are stuffed with cheese and herb mix and drizzled with marinara sauce.



...ndoori Prawn where juicy prawns ...ed with curd, cream, cheese and ...tter and cooked in a clay oven.



This pretty blue cocktail is called the Butterfly Martini. It is made with hibiscus and blue pea tea-infused vodka mixed with white clarified green apple juice and star anise.



Kasundi Beckty Chops are Calcutta's ca... style, crumb-fried fish chops served with tartare sauce and *kasundi*.

...ur offers some carefully curated ...e-made gin concoctions in various ...lavours like hibiscus, saffron, cinnamon, coriander, beetroot and many more. Adding these concoctions to your gin cocktail not only enhances the flavour of the tipple but also makes the drink healthy. Patrons can come to the bar and stir up their own gin cocktails using the house-made syrups.



The age-old recipe for Prawn Cocktail where poached river prawns are served with brandy cocktail sauce.



Try the aromatic Dhungar Gosht Korma, which is the chef's special charcoal-smoked mutton korma.





Vanilla Oreo Fudge Shake is for all the chocolate lovers out there. It is made with crushed Ferrero Rocher, mashed strawberries, chocolate sauce and vanilla ice-cream.



The Jungle Juice Cup is made with tequila, rum, vodka and triple sec mixed with pink apricot lemonade, pineapple juice and strawberry syrup.



Canja De Galinha is a popular Portuguese chicken soup made with chicken broth and veggies and served with rice.

Rohini Chakraborty
Pictures: B Halder

Recycle Bin Media

SONAR TORI IS CELEBRATING A SCRUMPTIOUS SEAFOOD FESTIVAL CALLED KANKRA GOLDAR GOPPO

Along with the nostalgic and Bengali heritage décor, Sonar Tori has been recognised as one of the top restaurants serving authentic and home-like Bengali cuisine. They celebrate different Bengali food festivals all year round and this year they are hosting a luscious seafood festival called the Kankra Goldar Goppo, where the menu includes a delectable array of crab and prawn dishes. These mouth-watering seafood dishes have a unique story behind them, as sous chef Bhaskar Dasgupta created these dishes inspired by the lost Bengali recipes that he learnt from the kitchen of his mother and grandmother. These authentic seafood delectables are made by following old Bengali culinary rules and with authentic spices, which make them more aromatic and tasty.



It's been more than a week of Kankra Golda Goppo at Sonar Tori and the response we have received is amazing. People are specially come over to enjoy this festival. The festivals of Sonar Tori are becoming a signature for the brand, as all the items on the menu are lost recipes which are curated in a beautiful way by our team. I would personally recommend all to come and indulge in it before March 15," said Nitin Kohli, whole time director, Ambuja Neotia.

What: Kankra Goldar Goppo by Sonar Tori
Where: Sonar Tori, B-Block, 4th floor, City Centre Salt Lake
On till: March 15
Meal for two: Rs 1,500-plus



Coxbazar Chingri Cutlets are crispy and marinated crumb-fried prawns served with special Bikrampurer Kashundi. Rs 599



The prawns in Murshidabadi Tawa Chingri are marinated in grilled garden fresh spices and served with garlic chilli sauce. Rs599



Spicy crab stir-fried in hot gravy made with garam masala and other house-special spices gives you Kankra Jhal. Rs 619



This unique dish is called Purbhora Kankra, where gratinated spicy crab meat is served in crab shells. Rs 599



Kankra Aam Kashundi has steamed crab meatballs are drenched in the home-made mango *kashundi* and the aroma will make you instantly salivate. Rs 599



Kalo Jeere Narkol Chingri is made with prawns tempered with nigella seeds and finished with coconut and mustard. Rs 639



End the meal on a sweet note with this soothing Daab Sandesh where soft homemade *sandesh* is placed on tender coconut slabs.

Rohini Chakraborty
Pictures: Rashbehari Das

UNO PIZZERIA AND GRILL INTRODUCES NEW ADDITIONS TO THEIR MENU. t2 CHECKS IT OUT

Uno Pizzeria and Grill still draws its identity and inspiration from the artisan heritage of the original Pizzeria Uno in Chicago, IL. Famous for its deep-dish pizza, Uno Pizzeria and Grill Kolkata has added a few more delectable dishes with intense flavours and a wide variety of sizzling cocktails to pair them with its menu. They have also launched their brand new liquid buffet, available from Monday to Friday from noon to 8pm, starting from Rs 79 only.

We could not wait to check out this tempting new feast, and here's bringing you our faves.



Enjoy the luscious menu with Uno's soothing and aesthetic ambience with its old-school American interiors. We love the neon sign and checkered flooring.



Cottage Cheese Quesadilla made in Uno's way by char-grilling quesadilla stuffed with cottage cheese, onion, pepper, mozzarella and cheddar, served with salsa and mint sauce.



Don't miss the seafood special, Carribean Seafood Rice, which is a savoury blend of sautéed shrimp, calamari, basa, and bell peppers and flavoured with butter and curry seasoning.



The Perfumer's G&T is a cardamom-infused London Dry Gin cocktail with rose, cucumber and lime ginger tonic.

Rohini Chakraborty
Pictures: B Halder



In-fresco Deep Dish Pizza made with fresh basil, pesto sauce, fresh mozzarella, caramelised onions and cherry tomatoes. A must-try for sure.



Jalapeno infused with fresh mango, triple sec, the tangy Tex Mex Chilli Mango Margarita poured in a lime and peri-peri-rimmed glass is a hot and spicy sip.

new menu

AAM BANGALI NOSTALGIA

Taste the flavours of mango in authentic Bengali cuisine at the ongoing *Aam er Utsob*

STEPPING INSIDE Sonar Tori in City Centre 1 we were instantly transported to old Bengal with its décor , ambience and music. As *Bhromor Koio Giya* played in the background we took our seats to experience the ongoing *Aam er Utsob* and the famed Bengali hospitality that the restaurant is known for, and it sure exceeded our expectations.

As the season of mangoes took over the city by storm, Sonar Tori also dived into the game with its *Aam er Utsob* — a specially curated mango menu that brought together old Bengal charm for the contemporary palate. Bhaskar Dasgupta, chef de cuisine, Sonar Tori, mentions, "*Aam er Utsob* is an annual affair. A lot of the recipes in today's curation are drawn from old Calcutta culinary notes. Say the *Aam Posto Bora* started around the time of Raja Ram Mohan Roy when widows were fed minimal food. We wanted to uphold old Calcutta eating habits and nostalgia through this festival."

We started off with the *Aam pora shorbot*. What looked like the same old recipe was, indeed, very different in taste and texture. Not only did the raw mango pieces add a sour crunch to the drink but the mango skin was also peeled, made into a paste, and used along with the pulp giving it a mix of savoury and sour flavours.

Up next were two starters — *Kancha aam posto bora* and *Aam kashundi murgi*. The *Kancha aam posto bora* was a delightful mixture of mango and poppy seeds, but what stole our hearts was the accompanying raw mango and coriander chutney with its exquisite taste and smooth texture. The *Aam kashundi murgi* with steamed oval-shaped chicken *keema* balls in sweet mango pickle-infused gravy gave the right punch. However, it could have been a little less sour for a starter.

When it's Bengali food, can *dal* and rice be far behind? The *Aam dal* made of *masoor dal* and chunky mango pieces with plain rice was simplicity at its best. The mango chunks definitely added a bite to the dal but did not overpower its inherent flavour.

The main course was a bowlful of *Aam achar diye mangsho*. The tender mutton pieces marinated with in-house mango pickle lent the mutton a sour flavour, which was a welcome difference from regular mutton dishes. For mutton lovers, this is the star of the menu.

To wrap up the course came the soft and creamy *Aam payesh* made with milk and raw mango pulp. This was a tasty and cooling dessert that had a balanced sweet and sour flavour, making sure neither of the flavours overpowered the other.

A visit to the Sonar Tori to try the delectable *a la carte* mango curation is definitely recommended till the season lasts.

Till July 15, 2023.
Price for two (approx): Rs 1,200 +

—Subhadrika Sen
Subhadrika.sen@newindianexpress.com
@sensubhadrika

Pics: Pritam Sarkar



Kancha aam posto bora

Chef Bhaskar Dasgupta

modern twist



Chana aam kashundi paturi

Aam pora shorbot

Mocha aam sol

Aam achar mangsho

DAWAT-E-KABAB BY BENGAL DHABA IS WHERE YOU WILL FIND SOME SCRUMPTIOUS KEBABS. t2 DROPPED BY

Bengal Dhaba is celebrating the Dawat-e-Kabab festival, where they have a curated menu including some unique and scrumptious kebabs. This festival is all about fusion varieties of kebabs. Every kebab listed for the festival has a signature ingredient that makes it special and the festival menu has a huge spread of various options to choose from, both in veg and non-vegetarian kebabs. Not only the classic Mughlai kebabs, but Bengal Dhaba has also included seafood kebabs with fresh crab and lobster and cooked with ingredients from different cultures and countries.

What: Dawat-e-Kabab Festival
On till: May 5
Where: Bengal Dhaba, 86, Golaghata Road, Ganga Apartments, ground floor
Timings: Noon-11 pm
Meal for two: Rs1,400 plus



(From left to right) Samudra Bose, Mohini Bose Singh and Rahul Singh, directors of Bengal Dhaba and Bengal Lounge said: "We proudly present to our beloved Calcuttans, the Dawat-e-Kabab festival. We always believe in the love for food and what every passionate food lover craves! We are having this festival for the whole month of April, celebrating Poila Baisakh and Baisakhi. We would continue with more and more interesting and exciting menus and events for all our guests."



Mughlai-style Murgh Kalmi Kabab has juicy chicken legs marinated in a special blend of tangy spices and grilled to perfection.



Inspired by a Rajasthani delicacy, Paneer Sooley Kabab are slices of soft paneer stuffed with peanut paste, and cheese and marinated with yoghurt, aromatic spices and grilled to perfection.



Shikari Maas Rajwara is a delicacy from Indore where mutton chops are steeped in a spicy tandoori marinade with a hint of cloves, and roasted until luscious and tender. Try it if you are a lover of spicy food.



Ditch your regular chicken wings and try Tandoori Wings where tangy American BBQ sauce meets Indian tandoori spices. Served with cheesy dip and mint chutney.



This South Indian fusion dish is where the fresh lobster is marinated with mildly spiced coconut cream, and cheese and grilled in a tandoor.



Achari Tandoori Crab is crab infused in *aam-kasundi* and cooked over a charcoal fire till crispy. This is where Bengali love meets Punjabi *tadka*.

Rohini Chakraborty
Pictures: Rashbehari Das

Recycle Bin Media



কাঁকড়ার ঝাল

লঙ্কা সর্ষে চিংড়ি ভাপা

■ **উপকরণ:** চিংড়ি ২০০ গ্রাম, কুরনো নারকেল ৩০ গ্রাম, হলুদ সর্ষে বাটা ৫০ গ্রাম, কাসুন্দি ৩০গ্রাম, দই ৮০ গ্রাম, কাঁচালঙ্কা ৬টা, হলুদ গুঁড়ো ১০ গ্রাম, নুন, সর্ষের তেল ১০০ গ্রাম, কলাপাতা ১টা।

■ **প্রণালী:** চিংড়ি মাছ ধুয়ে পরিষ্কার করুন। সব উপকরণ একটা বোলে মিশিয়ে একটা মিশ্রণ তৈরি করে তাতে চিংড়িগুলো দিয়ে দিন। এবার বোলের মুখ কলাপাতা দিয়ে ঢেকে, ২৫ মিনিট স্টিমারে বসিয়ে রাখুন। স্টিমার থেকে নামিয়ে নিয়ে গরম গরম ভাতের সঙ্গে পরিবেশন করুন লঙ্কা সর্ষে চিংড়ি ভাপা।



লঙ্কা সর্ষে চিংড়ি ভাপা

কাঁকড়ার ঝাল

■ **উপকরণ:** কাঁকড়া ৪টে, ঘি ৭০ গ্রাম, সাদা তেল ৫০ গ্রাম। **কাঁকড়া ম্যারিনেট করার জন্য:** দই ৪৫ গ্রাম, হলুদ গুঁড়ো ৫ গ্রাম, লঙ্কা গুঁড়ো ৫ গ্রাম, নুন, আদা বাটা ২০ গ্রাম, রসুন বাটা ৩০ গ্রাম, অ্যারারুট পাউডার ৩০ গ্রাম, লেবুর রস ৮ মিলি। **গুঁড়ো মশলা তৈরির জন্য:** পেঁয়াজ ৮০ গ্রাম, গোটা ধনে ১৫ গ্রাম, গোল মরিচ ৫ গ্রাম, রসুনের কোয়া ২০ গ্রাম, গোটা জিরে ২০ গ্রাম, তেঁতুল বাটা ২০ গ্রাম, নুন।

■ **প্রণালী:** ম্যারিনেট করা মশলাগুলো কাঁকড়ায় মাখিয়ে ৩০ মিনিট রেখে দিন। মশলা তৈরির উপকরণগুলো হালকা করে ভেজে মিক্সিতে গুঁড়িয়ে জল মিশিয়ে একটা মিশ্রণ তৈরি করুন। প্যানে তেল গরম করে কাঁকড়ার দু'পিঠ ছাঁকা তেলে ভেজে তুলে রাখুন। সেই তেলে বেঁচে যাওয়া ম্যারিনেডের মশলা ও ভাজা মশলা দিয়ে মাঝারি আঁচে রান্না করুন তেল না ছাড়া পর্যন্ত। এবার কাঁকড়াগুলো দিয়ে ১/৪ কাপ জল মিশিয়ে নিন। মশলার সঙ্গে কাঁকড়াগুলোকে ভাল করে মিশিয়ে নিন। দু'মিনিট রান্নার পর ঘি মিশিয়ে নামান।

Recycle Bin Media

FOOD

INDULGE IN SONAR TORI'S SCRUMPTIOUS MANGO FESTIVAL, AAMER UTSAV

Sonar Tori at City Centre Salt Lake is celebrating summer and the onset of monsoon with the king of fruits, with Aamer Utsav, which is on till July 15. This food fest has been curated with the lost recipes of Bengali cuisine amalgamated with mangoes. From chicken to fish, each and every dish has been exquisitely created using mangoes with different flavours. Whether it's Aam Achar Bhetki Bhapa, Aam Dal or Aam Doi, the dishes are made with both raw and ripe mangoes.

"With Aamer Utsav, we have tried to bring nostalgia to the plates by making every dish with the seasonal mango. We have created all the dishes on the menu with natural products like the summer softer, which is homemade. We want our patrons to visit Sonar Tori to experience our homely and flavourful mango creations," said Chef Bhaskar Dasgupta of Sonar Tori. Here are some of t2's picks from the menu.



Chana Aam Kashundi Patari is where a block of soft homemade cottage cheese is marinated with mango pickle sauce, wrapped with banana leaf and steamed. Rs 349

If you want something light to go with your steamed rice in the afternoon, try the Mocha Aam Shol, which is a sweet and sour banana flower broth. Rs 319

Aam Kashundi Murgh is chicken quenelles tossed with sweet mango-infused sauce to give you that sweet and tangy flavour. Rs 329

A bowl of hot mutton gravy is what a Bengali soul craves on a rainy afternoon. Hence try Aam Achar Mangsho made with homemade raw mango pickle. Rs 649

Dig into the sinful Aam Doi, which is simply mango-flavoured yoghurt. Rs 199

Rohini Chakraborty

Pictures: S Halder

THE ORIENT AT CITY CENTRE SALT LAKE IS HOSTING A THAI FOOD FESTIVAL WITH SOME NEW CULINARY CREATIONS ON THE MENU

The Orient at City Centre Salt Lake serves a satiating Pan-Asian spread in a chic space. The diner is celebrating a Thai Festival till July 15, where they are serving authentic Thai cuisine. From fish cakes to flavourful curries, The Orient Thai Festival has everything for your Thai food cravings. The dishes are a burst of Asian flavours as ingredients like kaffir lime, galangal, basil leaves, and lemon grass are majorly used. "Immerse yourself in a celebration of Thai cuisine at The Orient Thai Festival. Our culinary artistry and authentic flavours harmonise to create an unforgettable dining experience," said Chef Ghanshyam Das of The Orient. t2 checked out a few dishes from the festival.



Thai Yellow or Massaman Curry is made with chicken chunks dipped in the flavours of sweet basil, lemon grass and bird's eye chillies. Rs 349



Mun Pla is grilled Thai fish cakes. Crispy patties of fish mixed with curry paste, egg, spring onions, lime zest and fish sauce and served with sweet chilli sauce. Rs 449



Try the sweet and tangy Khao Phad Supparhat, which is pineapple fried rice tossed with egg, raisins and cashew nuts. Rs 369



Kai Phad Med Mamuang is chicken chunks wok-fried with cashew nuts, fresh mushrooms and sun-dried chilli in soya and oyster sauce. Rs 499



Tahu Goreng Kecap is crispy fried tofu tossed in sweet chilli and soya sauce. Rs 459

Rohini Chakraborty

Pictures: S Halder

Recycle Bin Media

প্রণালী: চিংড়ির লেজগুলোকে মাংস থেকে আলাদা করে নুন, লেবুর রস ও আদা বাটা মাখিয়ে রাখুন। মিক্সিং বোলে চিংড়ির কিমা, পেঁয়াজ, গরম মশলা, নুন মিশিয়ে মিক্স করে নিন। মিশ্রণটিকে দুটো আলাদা ভাগে ভাগ করুন। চিংড়ির লেজের দিকটাতে মিশ্রণটি র‍্যাপ করে নিন। হাতের ভেজা তালুর সাহায্যে চ্যাপটা করে নিয়ে ব্রেড ক্রামে রোল করে কাটলেটের আকার দিন। তারপর একটা বোলে একটা ডিম ফাটিয়ে, অল্প করে ফেটিয়ে নিন। কাটলেটকে ডিমে চুবিয়ে আবার ব্রেড ক্রামে রোল করে নিন। একইভাবে বাকি কাটলেটগুলোও তৈরি করুন। শেষে তেল গরম করে মাঝারি আঁচে দুটো করে কাটলেট সোনালি করে ভাজুন। কাসুন্দির সঙ্গে পরিবেশন করুন কক্স বাজার চিংড়ি কাটলেট।



কক্স বাজার চিংড়ি কাটলেট

food & drink

taste notes

INDULGE
THE MORNING STANDARD
FRIDAY, FEBRUARY 24, 2023 / KOLKATA

piscine pleasures

SEAFOOD SAGA

Premium Bengali diner Sonar Tori is celebrating offerings from the Bay of Bengal in this new food festival

BENGAL'S AGE-OLD love for seafood isn't a new tale to talk about. They are not just fond of fish, but zealously preserve and relish the traditional recipes for crabs, prawns and oysters that are further segregated according to the palates of East and West Bengal. Sonar Tori, one of the premium Bengali city diners, is famous for Chef Bhaskar Dasgupta's culinary wonders and has taken a cue from this to curate a one-of-a-kind *Kankra Goldar Goppo* consisting of 11 unique crab and scampi dishes.

"This is an annual saga conceptualised around the months of February and March every year since good quality seafood is available around this time. This year, the menu is slightly different from the previous year since there is no freshwater *bhetki* available at this time. However, there are a lot of items such as the *Kankrar Chingri Pitha* where crabs and scampi have come together in a single dish to celebrate their mélange of flavours, that absolutely make up for it," shares chef Bhaskar.

Each time we head to Sonar Tori, we find ourselves mesmerised by how chef Bhaskar's passion towards his craft is reflected in each of his delicacies. This time too, it was no different. The first appetiser, Coxbazar *Chingri* Cutlet, bowled us over with its crunchiness on the outside and how it melts as you reach the centre. Served with sweet chilli garlic chutney, these cutlets are flavour bombs. Chef also suggested we try the *Murshidabadi Tawa Chingri* which happens to be his own take on the dish with a dash of the traditional baganer moshla from the land of nawabs, thrown in.

"This year's menu is a confluence of tradition and creation since there are a few dishes like *Goalando Kankra Masala* which is a modern spin on traditional recipes. This particular recipe has been inspired by the famed Steamer Curry made with mutton. Similarly, *Chattagramer Chingri Masala* takes inspiration from Chittagong's fascination with garlic. In order to make the dishes amorepleasantexperience for connoisseurs, we have made sure to balance the spice levels in each," adds chef Bhaskar.

The bill-of-fare isn't only about light bites and appetisers since it also features some star recipes that taste best when paired with steamed rice. We settled for the *Shankarpuri Kankra* featuring a single, big crab sourced from the shores of the Bay of Bengal. Marinated with raw mustard oil and the goodness of mustard seeds, this pungent delicacy is more than sufficient for two. If you feel *Lonka Shorshe Chingri Bhape* might be a mustardy equivalent of *Shankarpuri Kankra*, you can try the *Kalo Jeere Narkol Chingri* for an off beat yet flavourful pairing with your usual carbs.

Price for two: ₹1,000+
On till March 14
—**Raima Ganguly**
raimaganguly
@newindianexpress.com
@ganguly_raima

Pics: Aniruddha Saha



around town



Paneer begum bahar

Awadhi traditions on a platter

Celebrating the exotic flavours of Lucknow, Awadhi period diner Oudh 1590's tenth edition of the *Great Awadhi Festival* offers a vast array of unique kebabs in both vegetarian and non-vegetarian options. Apart from traditional kebabs, there is also a unique selection of fish and seafood kebabs. "In this edition, we are offering a variety of kebabs including the mouth-watering Nalli Kebab, Mutton Adraak Ke Panje, Chandni Mala Tangri, Makhmali Chicken Tikka, Smoked Tandoori Lobster and Tandoori Pomfret besides other options in the non-vegetarian section. The vegetarian options include *Lucknowi Paneer Sikh* and *Hara Bhara Kabab* among others," say Shiladitya and Debaditya Chaudhury, co-founders, Oudh 1590.

The festival is on across all Oudh 1590 outlets. Meal for two: ₹1,200+, 12 noon to 10.30 pm.



Nalli kebab



Smoked tandoori lobster



Tandoori pomfret

tasting

Green goodness

Incorporating old cooking methods, Vedic's new menu is crafted from rare organic produce

IN A FAST-PACED world, we still love to fall back upon our ancient traditions, teachings, practices and flavours for solace. Vedic at The Westin Kolkata Rajarhat's newly revamped menu offers just that.

Showcasing hydroponic plants and bottles of organic honey, the property emphasises the value of slow cooking in proper utensils with pure ingredients and at the right temperature. The décor, paintings and music also add up to the mindfulness by soothing the frayed nerves after a tiring, stressful day. In Vedic, each major season calls for different sets of the menu, and along with a host of specially curated beverages, the vegetarian diner has a variety of local and regional delicacies upholding a wide diversity of Indian culinary culture and traditions. "Vedic is a modern interpretation of the Indian classic regional cuisine in the abstract form. We use rare organic produce which is locally sourced," says Soham Dhar, sous chef of Vedic.

The three meticulously crafted seasonal menus from the winter collection comprise *Himam*, *Hemanta* and *Sishir* and we were welcomed with a plate of roasted *papads* and *khakhras*, paired with three types of *achaar*. The experience kicked off with a piping hot *Kesuk Galouti Rasb*, made with India's most expensive and exotic *gucchi* mushroom broth foamed with strong flavours of *gucchi* confit oil, dehydrated and powdered *gucchi* mushrooms from the Himalayas. Naturally, it was flavourful and heartwarming. For starters, we tried the very delectable *Channa* Platter consisting of wood fired *makhan paneer* roulade, *kalmi soag*, tangy *makhani* sauce, *anardana* and mint chutney. The *Namkeen Gulab Jamun Ki Chaat*, which had crispy *chana* puffs, chole, pickled onion, *angoor kichutney* and nitrogen liquid was unusually crunchy.



Interiors



Rukmaphulam

For the mains, we had their bestselling Winter Greens *Saag*, a mélange of winter greens slow-cooked with rice and finished with white butter. Paired with Baby *Methi Thepla* and *Malai Gucci Kulcha*, it was indeed a filling option. We also tried their specialty *Vedic Pulao* which was made with black rice, organic peas, baby carrots and *masala wadi*. The meal wasn't too heavy and we ended our extravagant experience with a toothsome *Gajar Ka Halwa*, paired with homemade *kulfi*.

Meal for two: ₹4,000+
—**Dhuritri Ganguly**
dhuritri
@newindian
express.com
@DhuritriGanguly



Winter greens saag

মুর্শিদাবাদি তাওয়া চিংড়ি

■ **উপকরণ:** চিংড়ি ২৫০ গ্রাম, আদা বাটা ৫ গ্রাম, রসুন বাটা ১৫ গ্রাম, লেবুর রস ১ টেবলচামচ, নুন, কাঁচালঙ্কা বাটা ৮ গ্রাম, ডিম ১টা, ময়দা ২৫ গ্রাম, ধনেপাতা কুচি ৩০ গ্রাম, পুদিনাপাতা কুচি ৫ গ্রাম, ডিল কুচি ১০ গ্রাম, পার্সলে কুচি ৮ গ্রাম, গোলমরিচ গুঁড়ো ৫ গ্রাম, সাদা তেল ৩০ গ্রাম।



■ **প্রণালী:** চিংড়ি মাছ ভাল করে ধুয়ে নিন। চিংড়ির খোলা ছাড়িয়ে আদা বাটা, রসুন বাটা, নুন, লেবুর রস, কাঁচালঙ্কা বাটা দিয়ে ম্যারিনেট করে ৩০ মিনিট রেফ্রিজারেটরে রেখে দিন। একটা বোলে সব কুচনো শাক-সবজি, লেবুর রস, গোলমরিচ গুঁড়ো, সাদা তেল, ডিম, ময়দা একসঙ্গে মিশিয়ে একটা মিশ্রণ তৈরি করুন। ম্যারিনেট করে রাখা চিংড়িগুলো এই মিশ্রণে ডুবিয়ে গ্রিল করে নিন। তৈরি মুর্শিদাবাদি তাওয়া চিংড়ি।

মুর্শিদাবাদি তাওয়া চিংড়ি



Recycle Bin Media

t2 TAKES A LOOK AT 8TH DAY CAFÉ & BAKERY'S NEW BREAKFAST MENU

8th Day Café & Bakery has lined up a breakfast menu that will ensure that you begin your day by feasting like a king. Besides the variety of coffee that this place is known for, you can also savour dishes with chicken, vegetables, eggs and bread that have been curated to add a new dimension to your regular breakfast. t2 dropped by for a tasting session and here's what we loved.



"With this new menu launch, we continue our commitment to continually add new items and innovate at regular and frequent intervals based on feedback from our valuable community. Folks wanted more substantial offerings and hearty meals to enjoy - so we have launched more mains such as burgers, tacos and wings. We know many cafes serve these kinds of items but we focus on high-quality ingredients and superb execution. We also have added items you cannot find anywhere in Calcutta - most notably our array of unique wraps. The new tiramisu is designed to elevate our dessert experience beyond our bestselling bakery items - it is a must-try.... The iced caramel macchiato and lavender latte, reflect our continued drive to be the coffee pioneers and trendsetters of Calcutta," said Grant Walsh, owner, 8th Day Café & Bakery.



Vanilla Lavender Latte will wrap your mornings in warmth. The notes of lavender and vanilla infused in a coffee make for a light and refreshing treat. The design on top with the milk and milk foam, is all hearts.



Parmesan Shredded Chicken Sandwich has focaccia bread, melted Parmesan and mozzarella over shredded chicken and homemade tomato sauce. This sandwich can be best paired with black coffee for a wholesome treat.

Iced Caramel Macchiato tastes as rich as it looks. The coffee is made with espresso shot, crushed ice and cold milk besides a garnish of caramel sauce and chunks of butterscotch. The layers are distinctly visible and is one of the best beverages you can indulge in.





Peri Peri Chicken with Mash and vegetables has the chicken cooked in homemade peri peri spices with a flavoursome chilli basting mixed with oil, lemon, salt and garlic. It is served alongside sauteed broccoli, carrots, and capsicums and garnished with chopped parsley and stuffed with creamy mashed potatoes.

Turkish Egg and Pita bread is a signature item of the café. This classic egg-based dish has a yoghurt and peri-peri dressing at the bottom, topped with chilli and parsley oil. One can easily have this nutrient-dense dish with pita bread that makes for a flavourful combination.





This timeless, classic Italian dessert, tiramisu is made with egg, mascarpone, espresso shot, layered with ladyfingers and finished with cocoa powder and shredded dark chocolate. *#thebest*

Text: Ashmita Ghosh
(t2 intern)
Pictures: Pabitra Das

EXPLORE THE BEAUTY OF INDIAN CUISINE WITH THE RAMPURI FESTIVAL AT CONCLAVE AT AFRAA

Nothing screams fulfilling and comfort than North Indian cuisine and Rampuri cooking is quintessentially Indian, with a flavoursome blend of spices. At Afraa's Rampuri festival, you can now get your fill of deliciously warm and comfortably spicy delectables. From soups to juicy kebabs, soft naans and warm curries, a plethora of veg and non-veg delights wait for all.

"Rampuri cuisine is a delectable hand-crafted art from the kitchens of the households of Uttar Pradesh. This traditional cuisine's popularity is dwindling due to lack of recognition. Conclave at Afraa, City Centre Salt Lake is researching on such lost cuisines of India and Rampuri festival is the first of such food festivals that we bring to the City of Joy. Hosting this at Conclave at Afraa is the best way to revive the cuisine and make people experience royalty and history on a platter. Our chefs have curated a very special menu. We invite our guests to visit Conclave at City Centre Salt Lake and be a part of this revival journey," said Nitin Kohli, director, Ambuja Neotia Hospitality.

What: Rampuri Delights
Where: Conclave at Afraa, City Centre Salt Lake
On till: July 2, 12.30pm to 11pm
Meal for Two: Rs 1,200



Gulathi: This yummy Rampuri dessert topped with nuts, is rice based and similar to the Bengali *payesh*. Rs 259



Tar Quorma (Mutton): Indulge in this delicious curry where the soft mutton falls off the bones and the mildly spicy curry complements any rice or bread accompaniment. Rs 659



Dum Ki Murgh Pulao: Relish this light and aromatic rice option. It comes with bites of chicken and crispy, delicious *bereta*. Rs 439



Astish e Murgh: Move over your regular chicken kebab with this chicken tikka dish made with Rampuri spices. The juicy chunks of chicken taste best dipped in mint chutney and fresh onions. Rs 499



Sambhali Mutton Tikki: Similar to the *galauti* kebab, what's different in this one is that it is much more flavoursome, less oily, and chewier. Rs 599



Sheermal: So soft and good are these that you can even enjoy them on their own! Sweet and mouth melting, they can perfectly accompany both kebabs and gravies. Rs 129

Sudarshana Ganguly (t2 intern)
Pictures: B. Halder

ENJOY THE WINTER WITH THE BENGAL LOUNGE'S SUMPTUOUS MENU

The Bengal Lounge on VIP Road has launched its mouth-watering winter menu featuring classic dishes, perfect for the winter. From Mutton Kohlapuri, Thai Green Curry, and Tandoor Jugalbandi to Reshmi Kebabs, the winter menu is full with heartwarming and comforting dishes along with some refreshing mocktails like Melon Sour and many more.



The rich and aromatic Mutton Rezala has a creamy texture with a flavourful taste



Gobhi Gondhoraj is a unique fusion of flavours with earthy notes of cauliflower and the citrusy flavour of *gondhoraj* lime in a creamy sauce



Tandoori Crab is typically marinated with Indian spices and yoghurt and cooked in a clay oven till smoky



The royal Sikandari Rann is made by slow-roasting lamb meat marinated with a flavourful mixture of spices, giving it a distinctive taste.

Pictures, courtesy: The Bengal Lounge

cuisine

Traditionally sound

Chef Bhaskar Dasgupta of Sonar Tori talks about the importance of methods while working on a particular culinary heritage





Mishti sampler

FOR CHEF BHASKAR DASGUPTA of Bengali diner Sonar Tori, it was always in his stars to end up in the culinary profession, especially coming from a family that valued the methodical traditions of Bengali cooking. Even though he wished to be a pilot or in the merchant navy during his formative years, he was soon awestruck by the science of culinary spices. After working in multiple cities and experimenting with world cuisine, he decided to come back to his roots some 20 years ago to unearth the lost treasures of his heritage. Today, he is not only one of the foremost flag bearers of Bengali culinary heritage, but also a walking encyclopedia of the cuisine. We speak to the senior chef in order to understand his vision of Sonar Tori and how he is trying to uphold the nuances within Bengali cuisine.

"I have grown up watching my mother and grandmother create magic in the kitchen with their unmatched skills. My mother strongly believes that the only way to a person's heart is when the food is cooked from one's heart and with passion," shares Bhaskar. "I think recipes are just pure science full of mathematics and chemistry as the entire dish depends upon the number of spices, cooking process, blend of flavours, and so on. There were no spice powders at one point and women used to grind all the whole spices together on mortar and pestle. The passion and hard work that went into one dish is unimaginable today and that is what I am striving for at Sonar Tori," explains the chef. While delving deep into the heritage of Bengali cuisine, Bhaskar realised it cannot be simply defined by one set of flavours or ingredients since it depends on which region of Bengal each dish originates from. "Since my major focus is on the lost recipes from Bengal which are no longer cooked in the post-globalised Bengali household, it is important to pay attention to the spices being used, the preparations of which come with their own set of methods, which are an integral part of maintaining the flavours and quality of a particular dish," concludes Bhaskar.

Mail for ₹1,900+
— RG

FOOD



Bored of consuming the same regular chicken and veg parcels? Wild Mushroom Phyllo Parcels stands out as an exquisite treat for your taste buds. Featuring mushroom stuffed cream cheese parcel with Sichhuan sauce.



Burnt garlic chicken with sun-dried tomato cream comprises succulent pieces of Mozzarisse pasta stuffed with burnt garlic chicken. This is further tossed and served with sun-dried tomato cream sauce.

BIANCO ROLLS OUT A SPECIAL LOVE MONTH MENU, FULL OF INTERESTING FLAVOURS

While January gives way to the month of love, Bianco's special lineup is a celebration of just that. This quaint bistro offers a range of European delights that caters to patrons with a discerning palate. The curation reflects designer Rohan Pariyar's vision as an artist, who loves to experiment with culinary art as a manifestation of his creative pursuits. Consulting chef Ratan Das who puts his technical prowess into executing it. The menu packs in an eclectic melange of visually tempting and tasty flavours. Heading European vibes with contemporary notes and minimal alterations, these are some of the most sought after items that you can relish, while you are out on a date this Valentine's season. 12 checked out all that's on offer.

What: Love Affair with Flavours
Where: Bianco, 9 B, Ekdalia Road, Ekdalia, Ballygunge
On till: February 25
Timings: 11.30am-10.30pm
Pocket pinch: Rs 1,200 for two



BBQ Lamb and cheese is made with sourdough bread stuffed with barbecued lamb that is gradually slow-cooked, this dish is served with some lip-smacking fries and fresh greens to make sure that you have a hearty treat.



Harissa butter must grown has the strong scent of fresh shrimp chunks. The bistro's in-house harissa butter is the queen of this dish that is responsible for accentuating the flavours of roasted, marinated prawns and lending a smoky, peppery feel to the same.



Wildberry cheesecake is an ancient Greek mushy dessert that is presented with a twist by incorporating swirls of wild berry compote on in-house baked cheesecake. The compote provides a fresh taste to the cake and is a must-try to satiate your sweet tooth cravings.



Prawn bisque and paprika spaghetti is a signature dish of the bistro. This item is filled with the aromatic essence of prawns and prawn bisque sauce. It features spaghetti cooked in a rich prawn bisque sauce, along with prawn and paprika that adds a zing to each bite. A must-try!



Rose and Lichi Refresher is a refreshing drink that spells out the romantic charm in every sip.



"It's very instinctive for me to be into fashion. It's all about art. For me, it's art because all of the pieces are so personal to me. However, the idea of decorating, doing some sort of artwork and presenting food in a nicer way was simultaneously growing in me. I wanted to pursue both of them together, which is why, from this year onwards, I thought of shaping Bianco in the same way. I have been associated with Bianco since Day One because I was always fond of doing my creative bit there. Starting this Valentine's season, we have tried to put together a palate of flavours that have not been explored at Bianco before. We made sure that you eat through your eyes first. I believe, Calcutta is just very open to trying any cuisine, which further provides us with the ground to nurture ideas and thoughts on similar lines," said Rohan Pariyar, founder of Bianco.

Ashmita Ghosh (t2 intern)
Picture: Kaushik Saha

Recycle Bin Media

A POPULAR SALT LAKE HANGOUT GETS AN ALL-NEW LOOK AND FEEL. t2 CHECKS IT OUT

The party and hangout spot at City Centre Salt Lake, Mugs & Shots Cafe & Lounge, has been revamped into a new chill spot. It is now spread over three floors catering to all your moods. With each floor spread over 800sqft area, the ground floor has turned into a techno dance floor followed by the jacuzzi lounge on the first floor and, lastly, the dining area on the second floor. The 200-seater cafe and lounge serves a multicuisine menu with an elaborate beverage list. t2 checked out the revamped look of the place.

What: Mugs & Shots Cafe & Lounge
Where: City Centre Salt Lake
Timings: Noon-midnight (Monday to Friday); noon-1 am (Saturday and Sunday)
Meal for two: Rs 999-plus (with alcohol) and Rs 599-plus (without alcohol)





"We have revamped the second outlet of Mugs & Shots Cafe & Lounge in Salt Lake. Since the revamp, we have been receiving huge footfalls. The whole place is now a go-to place for all the youngsters who visit City Centre, but we also cater to families as our topmost floor is a dining area. In short, we have everything for everyone," said Anirban Deb Roy (right) and Anil Gupta, managing directors of Mugs & Shots Cafe & Lounge.



The dining floor has been kept minimal with a calming ambience and sofa seating for a comfortable experience.



The extended beverage menu has refreshing mocktails like (l-r) Lychee Delight, Kiwi Mint Cooler and cocktails like Honey-ginger Mojito, Orange Gin Cooler and many more.



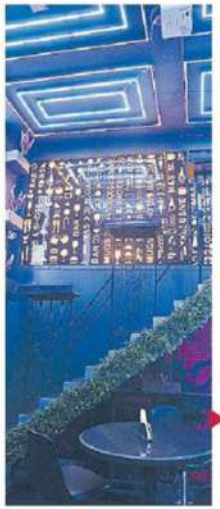
This vibrant green dish is called Chicken Pahadi Kebab, named after the green hills of India. The green kebabs are made with juicy chicken chunks marinated with fresh green herbs and roasted. Rs 399

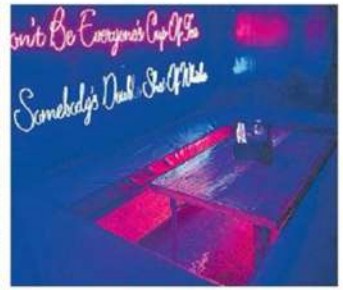


Try the classic Margherita Pizza with a twist, filled with fresh cheese and veggies in every slice. Rs 449



Pair the smoky and creamy Dal Makhani with roti or with the aromatic Veg Pulao.





Need a dose of mid-week relaxation? The lounge floor at Mugs & Shots is the perfect spot for you as you can dip your feet in the jacuzzi while you enjoy the mouthwatering delights.

The ground floor is the perfect setup for a weekend night out with techno lights synchronised with upbeat music.

Rohini Chakraborty
Pictures: Rashbehari Das

BIRLA ACADEMY OF ART AND CULTURE

Crafts Council of West Bengal
Artisana
Present

In Association with t2

UTSAV

India's glorious diversity, now in Kolkata, on a scale never seen before!

A Spectacular Kaleidoscope of Crafts and Folk Arts of India

Exhibition | Talks | Performances | Crafts | Weaves | Food | Fun

Last two days, only till 10th November! • 12 noon to 7.30 pm

Bibi Russel's Fashion Walk
9th November, 6pm

Priti Patel's (Anjika) 'Narta Sutra'
10th November, 6pm

Don't miss this!

Venue: Birla Academy of Art & Culture
108 & 109, Southern Avenue, 1st, 2nd, 3rd floors & lawns, Kolkata – 700029

Supported by:

SELVEL · Ministry of Culture Government of India · SENCO GOLD & DIAMONDS · CENTURYPLY · Bhavan

চিংড়ি কাঁকড়ার যুগলবন্দি

সি-ফুডে কাঁকড়া-চিংড়ির যুগলবন্দি মানেই হিট। এমনই নানা রেসিপির খোঁজ দিলেন শেফ ভাস্কর দাশগুপ্ত। চেখে দেখলেন দেবলীনা অধিকারী।

শঙ্করপুরের কাঁকড়া

■ **উপকরণ:** কাঁকড়া ২২০ গ্রাম, কালো জিরে ৫ গ্রাম, আদা বাটা ১৫ গ্রাম, পোস্ত বাটা ৪০ গ্রাম, জল ২০০ মিলি, কাঁচা লঙ্কা বাটা ৩০ গ্রাম, সর্ষের তেল ৪০ গ্রাম, সর্ষে বাটা ৩০ গ্রাম, কাঁকড়ার মাংস ৪০ গ্রাম, নারকেল বাটা ২০ গ্রাম, নুন, হলুদ গুঁড়ো ১০ গ্রাম, কাঁচা লঙ্কা ৪টে (চেরা), নারকেল দুধ ৪০ মিলি।

■ **প্রণালী:** কাঁকড়াগুলোকে কেটে নুন ও হলুদ মাখিয়ে রাখুন। সর্ষের তেল গরম করে তাতে ৫ মিনিট কাঁকড়াগুলো নাড়াচাড়া করে নামিয়ে নিন। সেই তেলেই কালো জিরে, কাঁচা লঙ্কা ফোড়ন দিয়ে আদা বাটা, হলুদ গুঁড়ো দিন। সর্ষে বাটা ও পোস্ত বাটা মিশিয়ে তাতে জল ও নারকেলের দুধ ঢেলে দিন। এবার কাঁকড়াগুলো দিয়ে, আর একটু জল মিশিয়ে দিন। সব মশলা দিয়ে আরও কিছু ক্ষণ রান্না করে নামিয়ে নিন। শুকনো লাল লঙ্কা ও নারকেল কোরা দিয়ে পরিবেশন করুন শঙ্করপুরের কাঁকড়া।



কল্প বাজার চিংড়ি কাটলেট

■ **উপকরণ:** চিংড়ির লেজের দিকে মাংস ২০০ গ্রাম, পেঁয়াজ কুচি ৮০ গ্রাম, লঙ্কা কুচি ২০ গ্রাম, আদা বাটা ১৫ গ্রাম, ধনে কুচি ২৫ গ্রাম, লেবুর রস ২ টেবলচামচ, কাঁচা লঙ্কা বাটা ১৫ গ্রাম, গরম মশলা ২০ গ্রাম, নুন, ব্রেড ক্রাম ৩০০ গ্রাম, ডিম ২টো, তেল ৪০০ গ্রাম।

cuisine

Tex-Mex treats

Uno Pizzeria & Grill's Festive Food Delights is all things spice and nice and a great choice for Indian palates



Exteriors

WHEN DEEP-DISH PIZZAS were launched by Uno Pizzeria & Grill in Kolkata, it created a stir among food connoisseurs that continues to date. A break from the usual cheesy Italian pizzas, the Chicago pizzas are to die for. The iconic American casual dining brand is also known for its legendary authentic culinary heritage of more than 75 years and its strong artisanal food craft culture; and its new menu inclusions called the *Festive Food Delights* has brought unique Tex-Mex flavours to Kolkata just in time for the winter.



Tex-mex fish and shrimp veracruz



Tex-mex chicken tchoupatoulis

Tex-Mex flavours include ingredients like tomato, chilli, jalapeno, cumin, and cilantro (coriander) — very similar to the ingredients we use in our daily cooking, making it a favourite among patrons here. We started with the Tex-Mex Chicken *Tchoupatoulis* which has a tender spice-rubbed chicken breast and bite-sized prawns cooked to perfection and served on a bed of herbed rice and steamed exotic veggies with a mildly-spiced brown gravy drizzled atop — a great choice for an Indian palate. Next, we tried a mildly spiced, tangy Caribbean Seafood Rice, loaded with calamari, bite-sized pieces of prawns and basa fillet bites and then to change the flavour track we opted for slices of Chicago West Loop Chicken Pizza — a thin-crust pizza topped with spinach, artichoke, grilled chicken, red pepper and parmesan cheese.

Soaking in most of the pre-winter evening, we also tried their Tex-Mex Fish & Shrimp Veracruz — spice-rubbed basa fillet and prawns, served on a bed of coriander rice, grilled veggies and gravy. We ended this very pleasurable guilt trip with a crunchy and refreshing Summer Citrus Shrimp Salad, loaded with the goodness of a variety of lettuce, avocado, bell peppers and shrimp.

Meal for two: ₹1,200+

— Dharitri Ganguly
dharitri@newindianexpress.com
@DharitriGanguly

UpperCrust
Food, Wine & the Good Life

CALCUTTA CALLING

Malini Banerjee

Broadway

27A, Ganesh Chandra Ave, Bowbazar, Kolkata 700013
Ph: 033 2236 3930
Meal for two: Approximately ₹2000 + taxes, with alcohol

One of the oldest establishments in the city's Central Business District, *Broadway Hotel* is known for being a favoured watering hole for the weary office-goer. The hotel that opened in the 1930s has rooms on the first floor with the bar-cum-restaurant downstairs. Having changed hands recently and with the reins in the hands of the young generation they are slowly but surely making changes while keeping their old-world charm intact.

This means that their popular deep-fried *Katla Peti Bhaja* is still very much on



the menu. Our favourites from our salad days include the *Indian Style Special Chilli Chicken* which is exactly what it promises to be. The *Chilli Mustard Fish* is another *Broadway* classic where the batter-coated



fish comes dressed in a zingy mustard-based gravy. The *Thai Basil Fish* is another good option amongst the Chinese-inspired dishes. The *Chicken a la Kiev* sets out to do as promised and comes with that oblong cutlet of chicken breast that oozes butter satisfactorily and is set over an Indian-style mashed potato. We washed it all down with a cold glass of draught beer which, as we all know, is easy on the pocket. and we skipped desserts, which we found had been added to the menu recently.

A POPULAR SALT LAKE HANGOUT GETS AN ALL-NEW LOOK AND FEEL. t2 CHECKS IT OUT

The party and hangout spot at City Centre Salt Lake, Mugs & Shots Cafe & Lounge, has been revamped into a new chill spot. It is now spread over three floors catering to all your moods. With each floor spread over 800sqft area, the ground floor has turned into a techno dance floor followed by the jacuzzi lounge on the first floor and, lastly, the dining area on the second floor. The 200-seater cafe and lounge serves a multicuisine menu with an elaborate beverage list. t2 checked out the revamped look of the place.

What: Mugs & Shots Cafe & Lounge
Where: City Centre Salt Lake
Timings: Noon-midnight (Monday to Friday); noon-1 am (Saturday and Sunday)
Meal for two: Rs 800-plus (with alcohol) and Rs 500-plus (without alcohol)









"We have revamped the second outlet of Mugs & Shots Cafe & Lounge in Salt Lake. Since the revamp, we have been receiving huge footfalls. The whole place is now a go-to place for all the youngsters who visit City Centre, but we also cater to families as our topmost floor is a dining area. In short, we have everything for everyone," said Anirban Deb Roy (right) and Anil Gupta, managing directors of Mugs & Shots Cafe & Lounge.

Need a dose of mid-week relaxation? The lounge floor at Mugs & Shots is the perfect spot for you as you can dip your feet in the jacuzzi while you enjoy the mouthwatering delights.

The ground floor is the perfect setup for a weekend night out with techno lights synchronised with upbeat music.

Rohini Chakraborty
Pictures: Rashbihari Das



The dining floor has been kept minimal with a calming ambience and sofa seating for a comfortable experience.



The extended beverage menu has refreshing mocktails like Litchee Delight, Kiwi Mint Cooler and cocktails like Honey-ginger Mojito, Orange Gin Cooler and many more.

This vibrant green dish is called Chicken Pahadi Kebab, named after the green hills of India. The green kebabs are made with juicy chicken chunks marinated with fresh green herbs and roasted. Rs 399

Try the classic Margherita Pizza with a twist, filled with fresh cheese and veggies in every slice. Rs 449

Pair the smoky and creamy Dal Makhani with roti or with the aromatic Veg Pulao.

BIRLA ACADEMY OF ART AND CULTURE
Crafts Council of West Bengal
Artisana
Present
UTSAV
In Association with t2
India's glorious diversity, now in Kolkata, on a scale never seen before!
A Spectacular Kaleidoscope of Crafts and Folk Arts of India
Exhibition | Talks | Performances | Crafts | Weaves | Food | Fun
Last two days, only till 10th November! • 12 noon to 7.30 pm
Bibi Russel's Fashion Walk — 9th November, 6pm
Priti Patel's (Anjika) 'Narta Sutra' — 10th November, 6pm
Don't miss this!
Venue: Birla Academy of Art & Culture
108 & 109, Southern Avenue, 1st, 2nd, 3rd floors & lawns, Kolkata – 700029
Supported by:
SELVEL · SENCO · Bijoyan

t2 GETS YOU THE FIRST LOOK OF THE NEW PET-FRIENDLY LOAFER'S CAFE ON SOUTHERN AVENUE

Ever thought how your pets feel when you go out to chill, leaving them behind at home? Even our paw-friends need to come out of the house and hang out sometimes. The solution to this is the newly opened Loafer's Café, which is a pet-friendly and a cool place for you to hang out too! With 36 outdoor and indoor seating, and the whole zone being pet-friendly, Loafer's Café is a loving and safe environment for you and your fur babies. There are a few dos and don'ts to keep in mind while you take your pet to the cafe, like pets should be vaccinated, only friendly pets allowed and the owners should be responsible for their pet's behaviour at all times.

The interiors are well lit with a little Victorian touch to it, with wooden floors, pastel walls and floral upholstered furniture. You can also sit outdoors under the blue sky and fresh air, which is a bonus point for your pets.

Loafer's Café is serving Thai, Japanese, Mexican and other continental cuisines, along with tasty treats, muffins and healthy meals for the fur babies. So next time if you are planning for a chill session, take along your pet too.

What: Loafer's Café
Where: P-559, Lake Road, beside Kamala Girl's High School and Vivekananda park
Timings: 8am-10pm
Meal for two: Rs 800-plus. Pet meals also available



The well-lit interiors with floral upholstered chairs and pastel walls add a Victorian touch to the café. The outdoor seating sticks to a mere green and white palette to add a touch of nature with granite walls, wooden tables with high suede-cushioned chairs and plants.

Glimpses from the launch...



Tolly diva Nusrat Jahan shares cuddles with this pawsome cutie. Dressed in blush pink checkered shirt and sleeveless blazer set, her hair in loose waves, she surely did keep it subtle yet classy.



Actress Ritika Sharma posed with her Shih Tzu, Fendi.



Priyadarshini Hakim with her daughter.



Mexican delight crispy Veg Quesadilla served with microgreens, sour cream and tomato salsa is a great veggie treat.



Loafer's Café Signature Roast Chicken platter in mushroom jus, served with poached egg, sauteed vegetables and French fries makes for a hearty meal.



Classic creamy Margherita pizza with three cheeses, Burrata, Mozzarella and Parmesan, topped with cherry tomatoes, sea salt and pizza seasoning.



A must-try are the Buttermilk Chicken Bites marinated with fresh yogurt, ginger and garlic, olive oil and Cajun spice powder.



Abhishek Dutta and Jayshree with their sons and pet.



Trina Saha with her doggo.



Nitin Kohli, director of Ambuja Neotia, said, "The idea behind making Loafer's Café Lake Road a pet friendly café was that why should our furry friends miss out the experience of a café. Even they want to chill once in a while and Loafer's Café is a place where we promise to give a magical experience to pet parents and the pets. The menu walks you through continental, Mexican, Japanese and Thai cuisines, with a range of especially curated coffees and mocktails. Drop by today for a wholesome experience for you and your furry friend."

Rohini Chakraborty (t2 intern)
Pictures: Kashibhari Das

THE ORIENT AT CITY CENTRE SALT LAKE IS HOSTING A THAI FOOD FESTIVAL WITH SOME NEW CULINARY CREATIONS ON THE MENU

The Orient at City Centre Salt Lake serves a satiating Pan-Asian spread in a chic space. The diner is celebrating a Thai Festival till July 15, where they are serving authentic Thai cuisine. From fish cakes to flavourful curries, The Orient Thai Festival has everything for your Thai food cravings. The dishes are a burst of Asian flavours as ingredients like kaffir lime, galangal, basil leaves, and lemon grass are majorly used. "Immerse yourself in a celebration of Thai cuisine at The Orient Thai Festival. Our culinary artistry and authentic flavours harmonise to create an unforgettable dining experience," said Chef Ghanashyam Das of The Orient. t2 checked out a few dishes from the festival.



Thai Yellow or Massaman Curry is made with chicken chunks dipped in the flavours of sweet basil, lemon grass and bird's eye chillies. Rs 549



Mun Pla is grilled Thai fish cakes. Crispy patties of fish mixed with curry paste, egg, spring onions, lime zest and fish sauce and served with sweet chilli sauce. Rs 469



Try the sweet and tangy Khao Phad Supparhod, which is pineapple fried rice tossed with egg, raisins and cashew nuts. Rs 309



Kai Phad Med Mamuang is chicken chunks wok-fried with cashew nuts, fresh mushrooms and sun-dried chilli in soya and oyster sauce. Rs 499



Tahu Goring Kecap is crispy-fried tofu tossed in sweet chilli and soya sauce. Rs 459

Rohini Chakraborty
Pictures: B Halder

UpperCrust
Food, Wine & the Good Life

Vintage Asia

JW Marriott Hotel Kolkata, JBS Haldane Avenue, Kolkata 700105
Ph: 033 6633 0000
Meal for two: Approximately ₹3500 + taxes, without alcohol



On the first floor of glittering luxury hotel JW Marriott Hotel Kolkata, the Asian fine-dining restaurant *Vintage Asia* had a menu that was, since its inception, a little skewed towards Chinese and Thai dishes when it was launched in 2017. The new menu now looks to correct that balance and focuses more on the Japanese end of the Asian spectrum of cuisines though the classics and popular items at *Vintage Asia* still remain – we are looking at you *Xiao Long Bao - Pork Tea and Har Gao.*

We began our meal with the assorted *Dim sums*, each as pretty as they were delicious. Breaking away from the stereotype of Japanese food being predominantly about *sushi* and *sashimi* they have focused on a lot of plant-based options like the *Edamame & Truffle Dim sum* and *Mushroom Dim sum. Sushi* also includes veg options like *Avocado and Cucumber Roll*, though we confess to being biased towards the classic *Spicy Salmon* and *Tuna Rolls* and the *Prawn Tempura Roll.* The *Nigari Sampler* with tuna, yellowtail and salmon is perfect with their punchy *wasabi.*



For mains, we dug into the soba noodles which was simply and subtly flavoured with sesame and black pepper that went well with the *Chicken Gai Yang* or *Thai Grilled Chicken.* If you want to try Japanese only then the *Kakuni Pork Belly* is the one, sweet, succulent.

Already stuffed, we really had no room for dessert. But when presented with a cube of glossy, chocolatey *Tanzania 63%* we took our inspiration from Oscar Wilde. "I can resist anything except temptation," he was known to have said. This was sheer temptation on a plate.

Loafers Café

559, Hemanta Mukhopadhyay Sarani, Southern Avenue, Kolkata 700029
Mob: 0 90737 05555
Meal for two: Approximately ₹1500 + taxes

Just across Vivekananda Park in the quiet residential and tree-lined area of Lake Terrace, the ground floor of an old Calcutta building has been modified into a pet-friendly café.

The interiors have been rejigged though some of the trademark tiles are retained and each room has separate nooks for tables. Also quaint and adorable are the small wooden hand-held games at every table, be it a small square with wooden crosses or a *bagatelle*. Past the biggest room is the small enclosed outdoor section with picnic tables and benches if you want to nurse a cuppa and take your furry friend outside.

On the menu, find premium baked goods from the pâtisserie and an expansive array of Continental classics and Buddha bowls. We loved their croissants which were fresh off the bakery.



We ordered a pot of Darjeeling tea and snacks first. The teapot came with a small hourglass, too, so that we could time our brew just right. It went down perfectly with the ham and cheese croquettes that were crispy outside and oozing with cheese. The *Buttermilk Fried Chicken* disappeared in a matter of moments. Amongst their Buddha bowls the *Chicken Krapow* is perfectly aromatic with its subtly "basilly" flavour and accompanied jasmine rice and crunchy *bok choy.*

For desserts it is impossible to go wrong with their fudgy and crumbly walnut brownie or *Wilton Red Velvet Pastry.*

If your furry pal would like a meal, there is boiled chicken and boiled eggs to order as well.

Recycle Bin Media

PR COVERAGES

Fashion and Lifestyle



JEWELLERY

t2 CHECKS OUT INFINITYY JEWELS WHERE AFFORDABILITY MEETS LUXURY

Infinitty Jewels, an ethical luxury jewellery store, has opened doors on Shakespeare Sarani, with a focus on simplicity and sophistication. The store offers exquisite pieces crafted with lab-grown diamonds. Their simple yet elegant and lightweight bridal collection radiates with delicate charm, embodying the essence of love and commitment. From classic solitaire rings to intricately designed necklaces, each piece exudes a sense of refined beauty, perfect for celebrating life's most precious moments.

Spread across 1,200sq.ft, the store welcomes you into a world where luxury meets sophistication. Indulge in the allure of the curated selection, from unisex bracelets, elegant pendant sets, rings and much more.

Lilac Love is a contemporary masterpiece inspired by the royal lilac hue, tailored exclusively for the discerning bride, radiating sophistication and style.

"At Infinitty Jewels, we believe luxury should be synonymous with sustainability. Our mission is to redefine elegance by creating exquisite jewellery pieces that not only dazzle the eye but also respect the planet. We are committed to sourcing materials responsibly and crafting each piece with meticulous attention to detail. Our journey is guided by the belief that true beauty should be timeless, enduring, and ethically sourced," said (l-r) Sharad Nakhat, co-founder, CFO and head of operations; Semanti Jain, co-founder and head of business development; Preeti Godwani Gupta, co-founder and head of marketing and media relations; and Rahul Kumar Gupta, founder, CEO and head of creative development of Infinitty Jewels.

Actors Noel Bhattacharya and Trina Saha dropped by for the launch

Rohini Chakraborty
Pictures: Rahim Das

The Rani Darbar is a majestic wedding extravaganza [illegible] to life by Infinitty [illegible] inspired by the [illegible] of Lord Ram [illegible] love.

With the Evil Eye Ring, embrace positivity and elegance with the stunning lab-grown diamonds set in 18k gold.

The Cubano is a gender-fluid statement piece. Comprising a Cuban chain and bracelet, adorned with lab-grown diamonds and embraced by the richness of rose gold, offering both exquisite style and sustainability.

TOLLYWOOD

BONNY AND KOUSHANI ON THE FRIDAY FILM *SUBHO BIJOYA*, THEIR DURGA PUJA MEMORIES AND MARRIAGE PLANS

Aviskon Chatterjee
Picture: Buddhadeb Das
Location courtesy: London's Cafe, Southern Avenue
Styling: Rahul Menon
Make-up: Trishna Das
Hair: Shah-dia Debdarsee
Outfit: House of Masaba, Ritu Vik
Jewellery: Tanchi Sonara, Ami Sonara

PETS

SPOIL YOUR FOUR-LEGGED FRIEND AT **THE PAW STORY**, A PET SPA. **t2** CHECKS IT OUT

You can count the number of pet-friendly spaces that are there in Calcutta offering services related to pets. The Paw Story, a grooming centre, clinic, pet boarding and pool, in Picnic Garden, is one of them. We recently had a pawsome day at the space with Nussrat Jahan's dogs Justice and Bruace coming down for a swim and spa... and we met some other pooches too.

The best part about the pool? It's big enough for a session, it's cleaned manually, trainers are always with your pets and there are toys that pets can play with. As the furry community splishes and splashes water around, the pool is cleaned immediately after a pre-booked session; the staff is caring enough to blow-dry the pooches and they come away happy.

The spa packages include a basic spa bath, hygiene essentials, full grooming, tick treatment, oil massage and a pedicure and manicure — all of these take care of ear cleaning, cleaning of glands, oral hygiene, bath, scrub, paw cream, perfume and is the ultimate solution after your furry bud plans on getting all muddy. The best part about The Paw Story is that the space also houses 26 indies — rescued and cured by the founder Ekta Gupta. She has isolated cells for dogs who undergo treatment. From cats with amputated paws to dogs with paralysed hinds, The Paw Story has a little something for the four-legged community. *#WeLove*

What: Pet Spa and Pet Swimming at The Paw Story
Where: 214 Picnic Garden Road
Pre-booking: 8100664748 / 8420674749
Pocket pinch for swimming: Starts at ₹799
Pocket pinch for spa: Basic package starts at ₹799



Irma loves the t2 camera!



Softy was all ready for a spa day at The Paw Story.



Big boy Bruace loves playing in The Paw Story pool.



Paw Story owner Ekta Gupta with Bruace and Justice.



"Justice and Bruace are both playful kids. Since both the breeds (Rottweiler and Cane Corso) need lots of physical and mental exercise, we play and train them. They love playing tug and fetch and since swimming is great for their hinds, we prefer sending them to The Paw Story. Bruace (a Rottweiler) loves playing in the pool. This serves both the purpose of exercise and fun," said pet mom and actor Nussrat Jahan.

Sramana Ray
Pictures: Biswajit Kundu and The Paw Story



8 অনা সময়

ড্রেসিং টেবিল

ফ্যাশন ট্রেন্ড

নানা ভাবে লাল সাদা

আমাদের প্রত্যেকেরই আলমারিতে একটা লাল-সাদা শাড়ি আছে। একই শাড়ি কীভাবে নানারকম ভাবে পরবেন? টিপস দিচ্ছে 'অনা সময়'

এখানে ট্রেন্সি একেবারে আলাদা। বিশেষ আকারে একরকমভাবে এই একই শাড়ি পরা যেতে পারে

গ্রামবাংলার বেশ আধুনিক। লাল পাড় কোরা এই শাড়িটির সঙ্গে পরানো হয়েছে ঝাড়-জোয়াইটি লেসের ব্লাউজ, খালি হাতিয়া। তাতে গয়নাতে সাজ একেবারে সম্পূর্ণ

সাদা শাড়ির সঙ্গে রুদ্রাক্ষ গয়না অবশ্যই ভালো মানায়। সাদা-লাল জামদানি ব্লাউজের সঙ্গে মানিয়েছে বেশ। এই শাড়িটির ট্রেন্সি-এ কিছু আছে অভিজাত্য

সাধারণ ভাবে পরা শাড়ি, লাল ব্লাউজটি হাইলাইট, লাল টিপ আর সোনালি গয়না সবমিলে এই লুক কখনও পুরোনো হয় না

ইছামতীর ধারে

টাকিতে চলছিল যশ-নুসরতের ছবি 'মেন্টাল'-এর শুটিং। সফরসঙ্গী আনন্দ প্লাস



শটের ফাঁকে নুসরত-যশ



বাবা যাদব



সাজছেন তিনি

দু'পাশে পাটের খেত, সার বেঁধে শুওচ্ছে দেওয়া আছে পাট। আরও এগোলে ইছামতীর পাড়। গন্তব্য টকার ২.৪ পরদনার টাকি। কলেজ মোড় থেকে বাঁ দিকে কিছুটা এগোতেই ভবনাথ হাইস্কুল। রবিবারের ভাবতেও ঝুলটি জুড়ে ছেলেমেয়েদের হইচই! কেনও শুটিং চলছে যে। বাবা যাদব পরিচালিত, যশ লশগুপ্ত ও নুসরত জাহান প্রযোজিত ও অভিনীত 'মেন্টাল'-এর সেট পড়েছিল এই স্কুলেই। স্কুল প্রাঙ্গণে কড়ের পতিতে গাড়ি চালিয়ে ঢুকলেন যশ। দেশখ্যে ব্রোয়ারের সাহায্যে ওড়ানো হচ্ছিল চকচকে কাগজকুচি। ছবিতে পুলিশ অফিসারের চরিত্রে যশ। গাড়ি থেকে নেমে সনগ্লাস খুললেন। হাতে কালো ব্যাগ। স্কুলে চুকির একটি খালার তদন্তে এসেছেন তিনি। পুলিশের পোশাকের সঙ্গে সনগ্লাস মনে করাতেই পারে সলমন খানের 'দবং' লুক। তবে চুলবুল পাণ্ডের চেয়ে অনেকটাই আলাদা তাঁর চরিত্র, জানা গেল যশের কাছ থেকেই।

মেকেতে ছড়িয়ে পড়া কাগজকুচি নিয়ে খেলতে চলে এসেছিল বাচ্চারা। কিন্তু শট তখনও শেষ না হওয়ায় হতাশ হয়ে ফিরে যেতে হল তাদের। ও দিকে ছিমছাম পোশাকে মনিটরে চোখ নুসরতের। ছবিতে মিশনারি স্কুলের শিক্ষিকার চরিত্রে নুসরত। তাঁর শটের তখনও ঢের দেরি। বাচ্চাদের নিয়ে শুটিং করতে কেমন লাগছে? "মা হয়েছি দু'বছর হতে চলল। কিন্তু আজ আমি ৩৫-৪০টি বাচ্চার মা। কেউ আমার কোলে ঘুমিয়ে পড়ছে, কেউ হোঁচট খাচ্ছে, কেউ আবার শট দিতে ঠেকে ফেলছে। বাচ্চাদের কুলিয়েকাজিয়ে শুটিং করানোর কৌশল শিখছি।"

পরের শট ইছামতীর তীরে। 'মেন্টাল'-এর হাত ধরেই দীর্ঘ দিন পরে বাংলা ছবিতে সায়ন্তনী ঘোষ। যশের বিপরীতে খল চরিত্রে দেখা যাবে তাঁকে। ছবিতে দু'জনের প্রথম বার দেখা হওয়ার দৃশ্যটির জন্য প্রস্তুতি চলার মুহূর্তেই নেমে এল অন্ধকার। সঙ্গে লোডশে বাতাস। বাধ্য হয়ে শুটিং বন্ধ করে দিতে হল। দুশ্চিন্তায় প্রযোজক দম্পতিও। অভিনয় ও প্রযোজনা, কোনটা বেশি কঠিন? "কোনওটাই নয়। দর্শক সিনেমা হলে যাবেন যশ-নুসরতের ছবি দেখতে। প্রযোজক হিসেবে সমস্যার কথা তাঁদের জানার বিষয় নয়। আমি যখন শট দিচ্ছি, নুসরত প্রোডাকশন সামলাচ্ছে। আবার একসঙ্গে শটের সময় বড় কোনও সমস্যা এলে দু'জনে মিলেই তাড়াতাড়ি দেখছি সেটা।"

টাকিতে এই প্রথম এলেন সায়ন্তনী। ইছামতীর তীরে মেঘ ও নদীর একাকার হওয়ার দৃশ্য মুঠোফোনে বন্দি করছিলেন তিনি। "কলকাতার কাছে এত সুন্দর জায়গায় শুটিং, সঙ্গে ঘরোয়া বাঙালি খাওয়াদাওয়া... আর কী চাই! বেশি মুহূর্বির ঘোল আর মাথা সন্দেশের স্বাদ কুলব না," বললেন তিনি। তাঁর কথার রেশ টেনেই নুসরত বললেন, "বসিরহাটের সাসেদ হওয়ার পরে মনে হয়েছিল, টলিউড বোলপুর, বাড়গ্রামে শুটিং করলেও টকির কথা আগে ভাবেনি কেন? দুই বাংলার সীমান্তের এই শহরের সঙ্গে আমাদের গল্পেরও মিল রয়েছে।" শুটিংয়ের পাশাপাশি টাকির মানুষের অসুবিধে-অভিযোগের কথাও সাসেদ-অভিনেত্রী টুকে রাখছিলেন ডায়েরিতে।

শট শেষে যশ ফিরলেন নুসরতের কাছে। স্ত্রীর কপালে তাঁর হাতের আদরো চাপ। কারণ নুসরতের শরীরে তখন জ্বরের আগম আঁচাস। এ দিকে পরের শট তাঁরই। ইছামতীর হাওয়ায় নিজেকে তরতাজা রাখার প্রাণপণ চেষ্টা করছেন তখন অভিনেত্রী। কারণ, দ্য শো মাস্ট গো অন...

ঈজিতা বসু

ছবি: অনির্বাণ চক্রবর্তী



চিংড়ি, মাটন

ইতালি স্বাদু

সব আমিষ পদের

রান্নাপ্রণালী

শিফন সমাদরে

শাবণ সাজে নুসরত জাহান









BEAUTY

t2 GETS YOU THE FIRST LOOK OF THE RENOVATED AN JOHN SALON ON GURUSADAY ROAD AND GLIMPSES OF THE LAUNCH PARTY

The revamped AN John Salon on Gurusaday Road is a realm of style, beauty and grooming. After undergoing a transformative makeover, the salon now features a blend of contemporary aesthetics and cutting-edge services. The chic interiors, adorned with modern furnishings and ambient lighting, create an inviting atmosphere for clients seeking a luxurious den for their beauty needs. They also have a skilled team of stylists who stay familiar with the latest trends and techniques. The salon has introduced futuristic treatments, from personalised hair designs to rejuvenating skincare rituals. AN John opened doors to their revamped salon with a dazzling launch party. Glimpses.



The revamped haircut zone has a touch of silver futuristic vibe. Experience crafted cuts by expert stylists in a chic, modern ambience.



Pamper yourself with nail art and care services at the luxurious nail art zone that features high-quality products and La-Z-Boy seats for long-lasting manicures.



The zones are well- lit and chic.



"We aimed to create a sanctuary of style and indulgence, where every detail reflects opulence. Our revamped salon is not just a space, it's an experience where luxury meets innovation. With passion as our guide, we welcome you to a haven of beauty redefined. Elevate your senses, you deserve the extraordinary," said Raman Bhardwaj, owner of AN John Salons, with Monisha Bhatia, head of education of Kerastase.

GLIMPSES OF THE LAUNCH PARTY



Rupali Basu



Vanita Bajoria



Tridha Choudhury had a fresh hair makeover by owner Raman Bhardwaj at AN John Salon. She said, "I think the newly revamped look of AN John Salon is completely fantastic. I like the European touch to the interiors. I got a hair makeover by Raman, which was very special, and wishing him and the salon all the very best."



Mariam Zaki with Kushal Mehta



Sonika Dey of Bunaphile



Navonil Das



Preeyam Budhia



Satrajit Sen



Johanne Mantosh

Rohini Chakraborty

Pictures: B Halder and A N John Salon

Films & Music

'WE WANT TO TELL STORIES FROM OUR SURROUNDINGS AND MAKE MUSIC, WHICH WILL HAVE AN IMPACT ON PEOPLE' — HIP-HOP ARTISTE **EPR** TALKS ABOUT HIS BAND ARTIVISM IN ACTION



বর্তমান বিনোদন

যশ ও নুসরতের নতুন সংসারে



Recycle Bin Media



STORIES FROM THE SHOOT OF *GHORE PHERAR GAAN*





Film-maker Aritra Sen *(picture above)* has wrapped up the shoot of *Ghore Pherar Gaan*, starring Parambrata Chattopadhyay and Ishaa Saha *(pictures left)*. "*Ghore Pherar Gaan* is a passionate love story about people trying to make tough choices. It took a lot out of me to envision the characters and their world. Now we have come to the end of the principal photography of the film. Will try to blend my vision with what we have canned on the edit table and prepare the final cut. *Ghore Pherar Gaan* (written by Aritra Sen and Soumyasree Ghosh) is a relationship story. It is a love story woven through music. It is a film in which the characters challenge the status quo instead of accepting it," said Aritra.

Ghore Pherar Gaan is produced by Ashok Dhanuka and Himanshu Dhanuka of Eskay Movies. The last day of shoot saw Ishaa Saha going through some important scenes at Xrong Place.

"After the London leg of the shoot it was straight to the edit table for me as my editor Sumit Chowdhury and I planned out the timeline for the film. Almost 50 per cent of the film had been shot in London and only small bits were there to be shot in Calcutta. We wanted to have an objective perspective before shooting the India sequences so that we do not end up chopping things off at the edit table. Hence we took a two-month hiatus and then planned the Calcutta leg of the shoot after having a rough cut in place. Parambrata's character travels back to his ancestral house and we created a set for that house in Burdwan Rajbari. There were also a couple of sequences involving Ishaa, which I will not reveal now," said Aritra.

Pictures: B. Halder

EPR CHATS WITH **t2** ABOUT HIS THOUGHT-PROVOKING AND CONCEPT-DRIVEN EP *UNCERTAINTY PRINCIPLE* AND MORE



One of the most prominent faces in the Indian hip-hop scene and a squad boss or judge in MTV Hustle (a platform for emerging Indian hip-hop artistes), EPR Iyer kickstarted his solo journey after parting ways with his Calcutta-based former band Underground Authority this year. After gaining immense fame with *Protest Poetry* he's released his latest album, *Uncertainty Principle - The Feel Good Project*. It explores the realm of endless possibilities and draws inspiration from existential and nihilist philosophies.

On the cusp of reaching a remarkable milestone of one million Spotify listeners, EPR chats with **t2** about his album, his journey and more...

There's a prelude and an epilogue to the album. Why did you incorporate those?

Uncertainty Principle is a thought-provoking concept-driven rap album that intricately weaves Heisenberg's quantum theory into its lyrical fabric, metaphorically. Through imagery-laden poetic verses, it explores the unpredictable nature of life, where circumstances can be as elusive as subatomic particles. The album also draws inspiration from Albert Camus' philosophy of embracing life's inherent meaninglessness and encourages listeners to live it to the fullest, finding purpose in the midst of chaos. This is why, there is a prologue establishing the context, serving as a foundation for a sonic voyage which is then completed, with the epilogue of hope.

It seems like you're telling a story through the numbers. Can you explain the story?

The album consists of eight unique individual tracks and one skit interlude, each of which has its own distinctly cadenced sonorous story to tell and yet is connected to the mother theme of *Uncertainty Principle* in all its entirety. For example, *Never Lose Focus* is a purely motivational piece which talks about overcoming obstacles and sparks up the spirit of never giving up in life, over alt-pop and hip-hop infused soundscape, while *Rock Fort* is a motivational piece as well, but it delves deeper into the hardships I have faced personally over an industrial-hip hop beat laced with South Indian devotional folk elements.

What inspired you to create this?

The concept was lurking in and around the corners of my head for quite some time, since the beginning of this year, but then the drive to make it come alive, in the format of an album/EP, developed much later. Quantum Physics, philosophy, abstractionist poetry, anime and existential thoughts coupled with some personal experiences, all served as a primary inspiration for this feel-good project.

Can you reflect on the journey of recording this album?

The process started, with me, brainstorming a million ideas and thus penning my thoughts on a piece of paper and then heading to the studio, to work with GJ Storm (Kuntal De), who is also my bandmate and the one who took charge of production, programming, mix and masters for the project. We took on completing each song at a time and once when we had all the songs ready, we collectively sat with the masters and decided the sequence of it, to give our listeners the best experience, sonically and so as to make all the tracks come together to be a concrete part of a single concept that drives throughout the EP.

What were the challenges?

The only challenge is that we are treading on thin ice or rather we are walking a thin line between complexity and simplicity, which we tried to keep in balance all throughout while exploring lyrical and musical themes in the EP.

This is your second album as a soloist. What else is in the pipeline?

A lot of collaboration tracks are in the pipeline! Shaikhspeare, Dee Mc, and Deep Kalsi to name a few, are the artistes that I have worked with recently and their respective tracks are to be released soon, within this year most probably. A full-fledged web series in which the audience is going to see me act for the first time and also, give music to, directed by Devanshu Singh, is to release as well.

So far how has your solo journey been?

My journey has been nothing less than a roller coaster ride for sure and I'm loving, every bit of it. Fully focused and determined to achieve all my dreams through music and to spread, the message of empowerment, through hip-hop.

We are loving you on (MTV) Hustle! What's your takeaway from it?

Hustle is like a family to me. It's my third season overall and my second, as a squad boss/judge. Every year, the goal, is pretty simple, which is to promote young hip-hop talent and give them the platform they need to showcase their art. I'm glad I'm associated with this legendary movement, that sees Indian hip-hop win super big on national television. Much love to the showrunners, the music producers, the contestants this year, my fellow squad bosses, Ikka, Dino James and Dee Mc and most importantly, much respect for Badshah, whose efforts have been incomparable on the show.

Sramana Ray
Pictures: EPR


SVF MOVIES
SVF BRANDS
SVF MUSIC
MUGS & SHOTS
Bar ★ Cafe & Hookah
LIZARD'S SKIN TATTOOS
TOO YUMM!
ANYTIME ANYWHERE
IMAN CHAKRABORTY PRODUCTION
VB VYAS BROTHERS
8th day café & bakery
Since 1760
Lewis Berger
Paint your imagination
Sylvan ply
break nahiin banta
AERMEDIA
BENGAL Dhaba
KINKY'S
SCRUMPTIOUS. SAUCY. MESSY
sunsilk
IMAGE CLINIC
DENTISTRY | SKIN | LASER | HAIR
REDISCOVER YOURSELF
jeetz
FILMWORKS
itel
Indian Silk House
ANJOHN
hairdressing academy
shaadi.com
L'ORÉAL
PARIS
TRINCAS
কলকাতা PRIDE
KÉRASTASE
PARIS
turtle
UTSAV
HOTEL AND BANQUET
TBL
THE BAR
&
LOUNGE
afraa
THE INDIA STORY
A NEOTIA ARTS TRUST INITIATIVE


McDowell's
No.1


AmbujaNeotia


S
FILMS


Service Before Self
CALCUTTA


KUTCHINA
THE KITCHEN EXPERTS


NEO
STORIES


ESKAY
MOVIES


COCO
CHARGE


streax
PROFESSIONAL


Sonar Tori


METRO


WOW!
KULFI


KWALITY WALL'S™


EST. 1943
UNO
Chicago
BAR & GRILL


BH
EST 1937


Reliancedigital


TGI FRIDAYS


MADAME
SIBARITA


Infinityy Jewels
LAB GROWN DIAMONDS & JEWELRY


EPR IYER


DAIKIN


WOW!
CHINA
DINER


INDIRA GANDHI MEMORIAL HIGH SCHOOL
DUMDUM
सत्यमेव जयते


WOW!
CHINA
LIVE CHINESE

Recycle Bin Media

















































